



Policies & Procedures

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2026

Version 2026.3
September 2026

**NATIONAL ASSOCIATION OF ADVISORS
FOR THE HEALTH PROFESSIONS**

**POLICIES &
PROCEDURES MANUAL**

Version 2026.3

September 2026

Copyright & Publication Information

NAAHP Policies & Procedures Manual

Version 2026.3

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This Manual is the official reference describing the governance, policies, authority, responsibilities, and major organizational processes of the National Association of Advisors for the Health Professions (NAAHP).

The Manual supplements, but does not replace, applicable law, the Articles of Incorporation, or the NAAHP Bylaws.

Questions regarding this Manual should be directed to the NAAHP National Office.

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Executive Message

Welcome to the **NAAHP Policies & Procedures Manual**.

Every successful organization relies on a shared understanding of how it works. Clear expectations, defined responsibilities, and consistent processes help leaders make informed decisions, volunteers contribute effectively, and staff provide the support that keeps the Association moving forward.

This Manual was developed to provide that shared understanding.

Whether you are serving on the Board of Directors, leading a committee, volunteering your time, or supporting the Association through the National Office, this Manual is intended to help you understand how NAAHP operates, where responsibilities reside, and how decisions are made. It brings together the Association's Board-approved policies, organizational structure, authority, and major procedures into a single, practical reference.

More importantly, this Manual reflects the way NAAHP strives to operate. Our success has always depended on dedicated volunteers and staff working together with mutual respect, a commitment to good stewardship, and a shared focus on serving our members and advancing the profession of health professions advising.

While this Manual establishes the framework for how the Association conducts its business, it is not intended to replace sound judgment, thoughtful leadership, or collaboration. Instead, it provides a common foundation that helps ensure decisions are made consistently, responsibilities are understood, and the work of the Association continues to move forward in support of its mission.

Like the Association itself, this Manual will continue to evolve. As Board-approved policies, organizational needs, and best practices change over time, the Manual will be reviewed and updated so that it remains a trusted and practical resource for future leaders, volunteers, staff, and members.

Thank you for the time, expertise, and commitment you bring to NAAHP. Your service strengthens our Association, supports your colleagues, and ultimately helps prepare the next generation of health professionals.

I hope you will find this Manual to be a valuable resource throughout your service to the Association.

Tony Wynne

Executive Director

National Association of Advisors for the Health Professions

September, 2026

About This Manual

The **NAAHP Policies & Procedures Manual** is the National Association of Advisors for the Health Professions' official reference for understanding how the Association operates.

It brings together the Board-approved policies, organizational responsibilities, authority, and major organizational procedures that guide the work of the Association. Rather than searching through multiple documents, readers can use this Manual as a single, trusted resource for understanding how NAAHP conducts its official business.

The Manual is intended for everyone who serves or supports the Association, including Board members, Officers, Association leaders, volunteers, National Office Staff, and members seeking a better understanding of how NAAHP functions.

Throughout the Manual, readers will find answers to practical questions, including:

- What is the Association's policy?
- Who has the authority to make a decision?
- Who is responsible for carrying out a particular function?
- How does a major organizational process normally work?
- Where can additional guidance be found?

This Manual establishes organizational policy and describes the Association's major procedures and organizational processes. It is not intended to serve as an administrative handbook or employee manual, nor does it document detailed workflows, software instructions, or other day-to-day operational practices. Those administrative procedures are developed and maintained separately to allow the Association to adapt its operations without requiring frequent revisions to this Manual.

The Manual supplements, but does not replace, the NAAHP Articles of Incorporation and Bylaws. The hierarchy of governing authority and the relationship among governing documents are explained in Section 4, Governing Authority and Delegation. (p. 15)

This Manual is intended to remain a practical and enduring resource. It is reviewed periodically to reflect changes in Board-approved policy, governance, organizational structure, and the evolving needs of the Association. Substantive changes to Board-approved policy require approval by the Board of Directors.

The following page, **How to Use This Manual**, provides practical guidance for locating information, understanding cross-references, and using the Manual as an everyday organizational resource.

How to Use This Manual

The **NAAHP Policies & Procedures Manual** is intended to be used as a reference rather than read from beginning to end. Whether you are serving on the Board, leading a committee, volunteering with the Association, or supporting its work through the National Office, the Manual is organized to help you quickly locate the information you need.

Each section focuses on a specific topic and is organized to answer practical questions, including:

- What is the Association's policy?
- Who has authority or responsibility?
- How does the process normally work?
- What approvals are required?
- Where can I find additional guidance?

Throughout the Manual, related topics are cross-referenced where appropriate to help readers understand how responsibilities and processes connect across the organization. When additional Board-approved policies or companion documents exist, those resources are identified within the applicable section.

As you use this Manual, keep the following principles in mind:

- **Policies** establish organizational requirements, authority, responsibilities, and standards.
- **Procedures** describe the Association's major organizational processes and the normal flow of work.
- **Administrative procedures** and day-to-day operational practices are maintained separately and may be updated by the Executive Director as operational needs evolve.

If you are uncertain where to begin, the **Table of Contents** provides a broad overview of the Manual's organization, while the **Index** can help locate specific topics. Cross-references throughout the Manual will guide you to related sections when additional context is helpful.

This Manual is intended to evolve with the Association. Suggestions for clarification, corrections, or improvements should be directed to the National Office for consideration during future reviews and revisions.

PART I

Association Foundations

The foundational principles, governing authority, and standards that explain how NAAHP operates.

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◆ KEY PRINCIPLE

NAAHP's mission and governing documents provide the foundation for all Association policy, leadership, and operations.

1. Introduction

About NAAHP

Founded in 1974, the National Association of Advisors for the Health Professions (NAAHP) is the national professional association for individuals who advise students pursuing careers in the health professions. The Association brings together advisors, educational institutions, and health professions organizations to strengthen the advising profession and support student success.

NAAHP serves as a national resource for health professions advising by fostering collaboration, promoting professional development, encouraging scholarship, and facilitating the exchange of knowledge and effective practices. Through educational programs, publications, conferences, volunteer leadership, and partnerships with health professions organizations, the Association supports advisors throughout their professional careers while advancing the quality of health professions advising.

The Association works collaboratively with member institutions, regional associations, partner organizations, and the broader health professions education community to improve communication, share expertise, and strengthen the advising profession. NAAHP also serves as a national forum where advisors contribute their experience, participate in leadership and service, and help shape the future of health professions advising.

How NAAHP Accomplishes Its Work

NAAHP accomplishes its mission through the combined efforts of its members, Board of Directors, Officers, Board-appointed Association Leadership, volunteers, Executive Director, and National Office staff.

The Board establishes policy, provides strategic direction, and exercises fiduciary oversight. The Executive Director manages Association operations within Board-approved policy, the approved budget, and delegated authority. National Office staff administer programs, services, systems, and day-to-day operations under the Executive Director's direction. Board-appointed Association Leadership and other volunteers contribute subject-matter expertise, leadership, recommendations, and service within the responsibilities assigned to them.

These roles are distinct but interdependent. NAAHP is most effective when authority is understood, responsibilities are clear, and governance leaders, professional staff, and volunteers work collaboratively in support of the Association's mission.

Related Documents

- Section 2, Mission, Vision, and Core Values (p. 12)
- Section 3, Governance Philosophy (p. 13)
- Section 16, Organizational Structure (p. 57)

2. Mission, Vision, and Core Values

Mission

The National Association of Advisors for the Health Professions (NAAHP) is an inclusive, interprofessional community dedicated to promoting the professional growth of our members and partners as they develop the next generation of healthcare providers.

Vision

The National Association of Advisors for the Health Professions (NAAHP) is the premier organization that educates and trains members and partners to support pre-health student success.

Core Values

i SOURCE LIMITATION

The available source materials do not identify a formally approved set of NAAHP core values. The redevelopment materials refer consistently to mission focus, member value, financial stewardship, long-term sustainability, transparency, accountability, inclusion, and collaboration. These concepts should not be presented as official Core Values until the Board confirms or adopts them.

Until a formal set of Core Values is approved, the Mission and Vision remain the Association's controlling statements of purpose and aspiration. Related principles are described in Section 3, Governance Philosophy, without being labeled as formally adopted Core Values. (p. 13)

Related Documents

- NAAHP Bylaws, Article I
- Section 3, Governance Philosophy (p. 13)

3. Governance Philosophy

Every person who serves the National Association of Advisors for the Health Professions accepts a shared responsibility to leave the Association stronger than they found it.

That responsibility is the foundation of NAAHP's governance philosophy. Leadership is an act of stewardship of the Association's mission, members, resources, reputation, and future. Individuals serving NAAHP are expected to act in the best interests of the Association rather than advance personal, institutional, regional, or professional interests.

Effective governance enables NAAHP to fulfill its mission, earn and retain the trust of its members, and ensure that current decisions strengthen the Association's long-term health. It requires thoughtful judgment, ethical conduct, responsible financial stewardship, transparency, accountability, and respect for the authority assigned to each role.

Governance and Management

The Board of Directors provides strategic leadership, establishes policy, exercises fiduciary oversight, and sets the long-term direction of the Association. The Board governs through collective action rather than through the independent direction of individual Directors or Officers.

The Board delegates responsibility for managing the Association's operations to the Executive Director. Working within applicable law, the Bylaws, Board-approved policy, the approved budget, and the Association's strategic direction, the Executive Director leads the National Office and manages the Association's programs, services, staff, finances, contracts, systems, and daily operations.

National Office staff administer the Association's operations under the Executive Director's direction. Staffing arrangements, assignments, and administrative methods may change as organizational needs evolve.

Volunteer Leadership and Service

Board-appointed Association Leadership, Action Committees, Working Groups, Task Forces, program volunteers, Ambassadors, and other volunteers contribute expertise, perspective, leadership, and service.

Committees and other volunteer bodies recommend, advise, develop proposals, and carry out assigned work unless the Board or another authorized authority expressly delegates decision-making responsibility. Volunteers do not independently establish policy, direct National Office staff, commit Association resources, or bind NAAHP.

The Association is strengthened when governance leaders, professional staff, and volunteers communicate openly, respect established responsibilities, and work together toward shared organizational outcomes.

Decision-Making Principles

NAAHP's decisions should place the mission first, create meaningful value for members, demonstrate responsible stewardship, support long-term sustainability, and promote transparency.

Healthy governance welcomes informed discussion, respectful disagreement, and a range of perspectives. Once an authorized decision is made, those serving the Association share responsibility for supporting its implementation and preserving organizational continuity.

Strong governance is measured by the clarity of authority, the quality of decisions, the stewardship of Association resources, the trust created through responsible leadership, and the enduring value provided to members and the profession.

Related Documents

- Section 4, Governing Authority and Delegation (p. 15)
- Section 7, Board of Directors (p. 23)
- Section 12, Executive Director (p. 40)
- Section 16, Organizational Structure (p. 57)
- NAAHP Leadership Code of Ethics

4. Governing Authority and Delegation

Hierarchy of Governing Authority

NAAHP operates within a hierarchy of governing authority. Each level must remain consistent with the authority above it. When a conflict exists, the higher authority controls.



Figure 1.1 Hierarchy of Governing Authority

The hierarchy, from highest to lowest authority, is:

- Applicable federal, state, and local law
- NAAHP Articles of Incorporation
- NAAHP Bylaws
- NAAHP Policies & Procedures Manual
- Board resolutions and other formal actions of the Board of Directors
- Administrative procedures established under delegated authority
- Operational practices used to carry out day-to-day work

Relationship Among Governing Authorities

Applicable law, the Articles of Incorporation, and the Bylaws establish the legal and corporate framework within which NAAHP operates. This Manual documents Board-approved policies, organizational authority, responsibilities, and major Association processes.

Board resolutions record specific formal decisions of the Board. Administrative procedures explain how Board-approved policy is implemented. Operational practices are the routine methods used to conduct Association business.

A lower authority may provide additional detail, but it may not change, expand, or conflict with a higher authority.

Governance and Management

The Board of Directors governs the Association through policy, strategic direction, fiduciary oversight, and accountability for organizational outcomes.

The Executive Director manages the Association's operations and determines the methods, staffing, timing, resource allocation, and administrative practices used to carry out Board-approved policy and direction, except where those matters are limited by law, the Bylaws, this Manual, the approved budget, or formal Board action.

National Office staff carry out operational and administrative responsibilities under the direction of the Executive Director.

Delegation of Authority

Authority delegated by the Board may be exercised only within the scope and limitations of the delegation. Delegation does not relieve the Board of its fiduciary responsibilities or oversight obligations.

The Executive Director may delegate operational responsibilities to National Office staff, consultants, contractors, or other authorized individuals while retaining overall accountability for the Association's administration.

No individual Director, Officer, committee, volunteer, staff member, or other representative may establish policy, obligate the Association, direct work outside their assigned authority, or act on behalf of NAAHP unless authorized by applicable law, the Articles of Incorporation, the Bylaws, this Manual, Board action, or a valid operational delegation.

Advisory and Volunteer Bodies

Committees, Working Groups, Task Forces, Association Programs, and other volunteer bodies act within the purpose and authority assigned to them.

Unless decision-making authority is expressly delegated, these bodies advise, recommend, develop proposals, support implementation, or complete assigned work. They may not independently bind the Association, commit funds, execute agreements, direct National Office staff, or represent a recommendation as an official NAAHP decision.

Related Documents

- NAAHP Articles of Incorporation
- NAAHP Bylaws
- Section 3, Governance Philosophy (p. 13)

- Section 5, Manual Administration (p. 17)
- Section 6, Policy and Procedure Administration (p. 19)
- Section 7, Board of Directors (p. 23)
- Section 12, Executive Director (p. 40)

5. Manual Administration

Purpose and Status of the Manual

The NAAHP Policies & Procedures Manual is the Association's official reference for Board-approved policies, organizational responsibilities, authority, accountability, and major organizational processes.

The Manual supplements, but does not replace, applicable law, the Articles of Incorporation, or the Bylaws. It is intended to provide a clear and durable explanation of how NAAHP conducts its official business.

Approval Authority

The Board of Directors has authority to adopt, amend, or rescind Board-approved policies contained in this Manual. Substantive changes become effective upon Board approval unless the Board specifies another effective date.

Proposed revisions may be initiated by the Board, a committee of the Board, the Executive Director, or another organizational body authorized to recommend changes. A recommendation does not become policy until approved by the authority responsible for that type of document.

Official Custodian

The Executive Director is responsible for maintaining the official current version of the Manual, coordinating proposed revisions, incorporating approved changes, and ensuring that the Manual remains accessible to authorized users.

The National Office maintains the official electronic and historical records associated with the Manual in accordance with the Association's records management requirements.

Editorial Revisions

Non-substantive editorial revisions may be made administratively when they do not alter approved policy meaning, authority, responsibility, eligibility, financial limits, approval requirements, legal effect, or substantive obligations.

Permitted editorial revisions may include corrections to grammar, spelling, punctuation, formatting, numbering, headings, typographical errors, and internal cross-references.

Any revision that could reasonably change the meaning, scope, effect, or interpretation of approved policy must be presented to the appropriate approving authority.

Document Control

The current approved Manual should identify its official title, approving authority, approval date, effective date, most recent revision date, version number, responsible office, and document status.

Only the current approved version may be represented as the active Manual. Superseded versions shall be retained as official Association records according to applicable retention requirements.

Periodic Review

The Manual shall be reviewed periodically and revised when necessary to reflect changes in applicable law, the Articles of Incorporation, the Bylaws, Board-approved policy, organizational structure, or the Association's enduring operational needs.

Periodic review should focus on accuracy, usability, authority, duplication, durability, and consistency with the Association's governing documents. Detailed administrative workflows should remain outside the Manual unless Board approval is required.

Related Documents

- Section 4, Governing Authority and Delegation (p. 15)
- Section 6, Policy and Procedure Administration (p. 19)
- Section 27, Association Records and Information Management (p. 89)

6. Policy and Procedure Administration

Purpose

NAAHP maintains several types of governing and operational documents. Each serves a different purpose, carries a different level of authority, and must be approved and maintained through the appropriate process.

This section distinguishes Board-approved policy from administrative procedure, operational practice, and companion guidance. It also establishes the general pathway for proposing and approving changes.

Document Categories

Table 1 Document Categories

Document Type	Primary Purpose	Approval Authority	Maintained By
Articles of Incorporation	Establishes the Association's corporate purposes and legal foundation.	As required by law and the governing documents	National Office
Bylaws	Establishes corporate governance structure, authority, membership, and procedural requirements.	As provided in the Bylaws and applicable law	National Office
Policies & Procedures Manual	Documents Board-approved policy, authority, responsibility, and major organizational processes.	Board of Directors	Executive Director and National Office
Board Resolutions	Records formal Board decisions addressing specific matters.	Board of Directors	National Office
Administrative Procedures	Explains how Board-approved policy and major operational requirements are implemented.	INCOMPLETE: Approval authority requires clarification	Executive Director and National Office
Operational Practices	Provides routine methods used to conduct day-to-day work.	Executive Director or delegated operational authority	National Office
Companion Guidance	Provides reference, training, program, or explanatory material that does not establish policy.	Responsible authority based on subject	Responsible office or program

Board-Approved Policy

Board-approved policy establishes official organizational requirements, authority, responsibilities, standards, approval requirements, limits, and controls.

Only the Board may create or amend policy reserved to it by law, the Articles of Incorporation, the Bylaws, this Manual, or formal Board action. A committee, Officer, volunteer, or staff member may recommend policy but may not represent a recommendation as approved policy before formal action is taken.

Administrative Procedures

Administrative procedures explain how Board-approved policy is implemented and how major operational processes normally move through the Association. They may establish reasonable administrative requirements, responsibilities, controls, documentation standards, and approval pathways needed to carry out approved policy.

Administrative procedures may not conflict with applicable law, the Articles of Incorporation, the Bylaws, Board-approved policy, or formal Board action. They may not create new Board policy, change delegated governance authority, or impose substantive requirements that require Board approval.

BOARD CLARIFICATION

The source materials are inconsistent regarding approval authority for Administrative Procedures. An earlier draft assigns approval to the Executive Committee, while the current redevelopment framework generally recognizes the Executive Director's authority to establish administrative procedures. This section does not resolve that substantive authority question. The Board should determine whether Administrative Procedures are approved by the Executive Committee, established by the Executive Director, or divided by subject and level of significance.

Operational Practices

Operational practices are the routine methods, tools, schedules, workflows, and internal arrangements used to conduct day-to-day work.

The Executive Director may establish, revise, or delegate operational practices within Board-approved policy, the approved budget, contractual obligations, and applicable law. Operational practices do not require amendment to this Manual unless they create or change Board policy.

Companion Guidance and Reference Materials

Companion guidance may include program guidelines, charters, training resources, forms, templates, instructions, and other materials that support implementation or understanding.

Companion materials do not establish policy unless the approving authority expressly adopts them as policy. They should be maintained separately when they are expected to change more frequently than the Manual.

Policy and Procedure Development Process

The normal process for developing or revising policy and procedure is:

1. A need, issue, or proposed change is identified.
2. The responsible individual or organizational body develops a proposal or recommendation.
3. The proposal is reviewed for consistency with applicable law, the Articles of Incorporation, the Bylaws, existing policy, financial requirements, and delegated authority.
4. The proposal is submitted to the authority responsible for approval.
5. The approved change is documented, communicated, implemented, and retained as an official Association record.

A matter that creates, changes, or rescinds Board policy must be submitted to the Board. A matter that addresses implementation or routine administration should be handled at the appropriate administrative or operational level.

Placement of Detailed Procedures

Detailed staff workflows, software instructions, file locations, naming conventions, internal checklists, communication templates, routine deadlines, and other temporary operational practices should be maintained outside this Manual.

The Manual may identify the responsible authority and describe the major process without prescribing every administrative step.

Related Documents

- Section 4, Governing Authority and Delegation (p. 15)
- Section 5, Manual Administration (p. 17)
- Section 9, Executive Committee (p. 30)
- Section 12, Executive Director (p. 40)
- Section 27, Association Records and Information Management (p. 89)
- NAAHP Policies & Procedures Manual Development Standards

PART II

Governance & Leadership

How the Board, officers, committees, and Executive Director exercise authority and carry out the Association’s leadership responsibilities.

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◆ KEY PRINCIPLE

The Board establishes policy and provides oversight. The Executive Director manages the Association within that authority.

7. Board of Directors

The Board of Directors is the governing body of the National Association of Advisors for the Health Professions (NAAHP). The affairs of the Association are managed by or under the direction of the Board in accordance with applicable law, the Articles of Incorporation, the NAAHP Bylaws, and this Manual.

The Board fulfills its responsibilities by establishing organizational policy, setting the Association's strategic direction, exercising fiduciary oversight, and ensuring that NAAHP remains focused on its mission and long-term sustainability. The Board's authority is established by the Bylaws, while this Manual describes the Board's responsibilities and its governance role.

7.1 Responsibilities

The Board of Directors is collectively responsible for:

- Protecting and advancing the Association's mission, vision, and long-term interests.
- Establishing the Association's strategic direction and organizational priorities.
- Adopting, reviewing, and amending Board-approved policies.
- Providing fiduciary oversight of the Association's finances, assets, investments, and reserves.
- Approving the annual operating budget and monitoring the Association's financial performance.
- Selecting, supporting, evaluating, and, when necessary, replacing the Executive Director.
- Monitoring organizational performance, significant risks, legal compliance, and progress toward strategic objectives.
- Ensuring the Association maintains effective governance practices and sufficient resources to fulfill its mission.
- Acting in the best interests of the Association rather than any individual, institution, region, or constituency.

7.2 Governance Role

The Board governs the Association through policy, strategy, and oversight. It establishes organizational direction, defines the outcomes expected of the Association, and delegates responsibility for implementing those decisions to the Executive Director.

Individual Directors do not possess independent authority to direct National Office staff, commit Association resources, or speak on behalf of NAAHP unless specifically authorized by the Board, the Bylaws, or delegated authority.

7.3 Fiduciary Responsibilities

Directors are expected to fulfill the fiduciary duties owed to the Association.

7.3.1 Duty of Care

Directors prepare for meetings, review relevant information, participate in deliberations, ask informed questions, and exercise reasonable judgment when making decisions.

7.3.2 Duty of Loyalty

Directors place the interests of the Association above their personal, professional, regional, or institutional interests and comply with applicable conflict-of-interest and confidentiality requirements.

7.3.3 Duty of Obedience

Directors help ensure that the Association operates in accordance with applicable law, the Articles of Incorporation, the Bylaws, Board-approved policies, and the Association's mission.

7.4 Collective Authority

The Board exercises its authority only when acting as a governing body through properly called meetings or other actions authorized by the Bylaws and applicable law. Individual Directors have no authority to bind the Association unless specifically authorized to do so.

Board decisions are implemented through the Executive Director or other individuals acting under delegated authority.

7.5 Relationship with the Executive Director

The Board establishes policy, strategic direction, and organizational expectations. The Executive Director is responsible for administering the Association, implementing Board decisions, advising the Board on operational matters, and managing the Association's staff, programs, finances, and day-to-day operations within the authority delegated by the Board.

The Board provides oversight of the Executive Director's performance while avoiding involvement in the day-to-day administration of the Association.

7.6 Composition and Organization

The composition, qualifications, voting rights, terms of office, vacancies, removal, meetings, quorum requirements, and other structural provisions governing the Board of Directors are established by the NAAHP Bylaws. This Manual supplements, but does not replace, those governing provisions.

Board Restructuring Transition

In June 2026, the Board approved Bylaw amendments implementing a revised Board structure, including two at-large Board positions open to members from any membership category and revised regional representation. The Board deferred the effective date until an implementation date is established. Until that date, the currently effective Bylaws govern Board composition and voting rights.

7.7 Related Documents

- NAAHP Bylaws, Article IV
- Section 4, Governing Authority and Delegation (p. 15)
- Section 8, Officers (p. 26)
- Sections 9-11, Board Committees (pp. 30-37)
- Section 12, Executive Director (p. 40)
- Section 14, Board Operations (p. 49)
- Section 6, Policy and Procedure Administration (p. 19)

8. Officers

The Officers of the National Association of Advisors for the Health Professions (NAAHP) provide governance leadership to the Association and support the Board of Directors in carrying out its responsibilities.

Officers exercise the authority assigned to their respective offices by the Bylaws, this Manual, and actions of the Board. Working collectively, they promote effective governance, provide leadership continuity, support sound decision-making, and help ensure that the Board's policies and strategic direction are carried forward.

The composition, qualifications, election, terms of office, succession, vacancies, and removal of Officers are established by the NAAHP Bylaws. This Manual supplements, but does not replace, those governing provisions.

8.1 Responsibilities

Collectively, the Officers are responsible for:

- Providing leadership in support of the Board's governance responsibilities.
- Promoting the Association's mission, vision, and strategic priorities.
- Supporting effective governance, ethical leadership, and sound decision-making.
- Preparing for and actively participating in meetings of the Board of Directors and assigned committees.
- Working collaboratively with the Executive Director, Board Committees, Action Committees, National Office staff, and volunteers in support of the Association's mission.
- Supporting leadership development, succession planning, and orderly transitions between Officers.
- Performing the responsibilities assigned by the Bylaws, this Manual, and actions of the Board.

No Officer may independently establish policy, direct National Office staff, obligate the Association, or act on behalf of the Board unless specifically authorized.

Officer Responsibility Matrix

OFFICER	Governance Leadership 	Board Meetings 	Executive Committee 	Financial Oversight 	Succession 	Records 	External Representation 
 President	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓
 President-Elect	✓	✓	✓		✓		✓
 Secretary		✓				✓	
 Treasurer		✓	✓	✓		✓	
 Treasurer-Elect		✓	✓	✓	✓		
 Immediate Past President	✓	✓	✓				✓

Note: ✓ indicates primary areas of responsibility. Officers work collaboratively, and many duties overlap as needed to support the Association's mission.

Figure 2.1 Officer Responsibility Matrix

8.2 Individual Officer Responsibilities

Each Officer fulfills a distinct governance role while working collectively to support the Board of Directors and the Association's mission.

8.2.1 President

The President serves as the Association's chief elected Officer and provides leadership to the Board of Directors. The President presides over meetings of the Board and the membership, promotes effective governance, facilitates the Board's work, and serves as the primary governance liaison to the Executive Director.

The President communicates Board direction through properly authorized decisions and does not independently manage programs, supervise National Office staff, or assume responsibilities assigned to the Executive Director.

8.2.2 President-Elect

The President-Elect supports the President in carrying out the responsibilities of the office while preparing to assume the presidency. The President-Elect contributes to strategic leadership, governance continuity, and the orderly transition of Association leadership.

The President-Elect does not possess independent authority over the Board, Executive Director, committees, volunteers, or National Office staff.

8.2.3 Immediate Past President

The Immediate Past President promotes continuity by providing historical perspective, institutional knowledge, and guidance to the Board and Officers. The Immediate Past President supports leadership transitions and performs other responsibilities assigned by the Bylaws or the Board.

The Immediate Past President does not retain the authority of the presidency or independently direct the work of current Officers, committees, volunteers, the Executive Director, or National Office staff.

8.2.4 Secretary

The Secretary helps ensure the integrity of the Association's official governance records. The Secretary oversees the accurate documentation and preservation of Board actions, meeting minutes, notices, and other corporate records required to document the work of the Association.

Administrative responsibility for preparing, distributing, maintaining, and archiving records may be assigned to the Executive Director or National Office staff. Such administrative support does not remove the Secretary's governance responsibility for the integrity of those records.

8.2.5 Treasurer

The Treasurer provides leadership for the Board's financial governance responsibilities. Working closely with the Finance Committee, Executive Director, and National Office staff, the Treasurer supports fiduciary oversight, budgeting, financial reporting, investment oversight, financial policies, and the Association's long-term financial sustainability.

The Treasurer does not independently make operational spending decisions, manage National Office staff, maintain accounting records, or assume administrative responsibilities assigned to the Executive Director and National Office staff.

8.2.6 Treasurer-Elect

The Treasurer-Elect supports the Treasurer as they prepare to assume the office of Treasurer. The Treasurer-Elect develops familiarity with the Association's financial condition, policies, budgeting process, financial reporting, investments, reserves, internal controls, and fiduciary responsibilities to support an orderly transition of financial leadership.

The Treasurer-Elect does not independently exercise the authority of the Treasurer unless formally authorized or serving in that capacity as permitted by the Bylaws.

8.3 Relationship with the Executive Director and National Office Staff

Officers provide governance leadership. The Executive Director provides executive and operational leadership.

Officers may request information reasonably necessary to fulfill their governance responsibilities. Requests requiring significant staff time or organizational resources should ordinarily be coordinated through the Executive Director to ensure appropriate prioritization, consistent communication, and effective management of Association operations.

Except as authorized by the Board or delegated by the Executive Director, individual Officers shall not:

- Supervise or evaluate National Office staff.
- Assign work directly to National Office staff.
- Direct the Association's day-to-day operations.
- Approve operational expenditures outside delegated authority.
- Negotiate or execute contracts on behalf of the Association.
- Establish Association policy independently.

Nothing in this section limits appropriate communication and collaboration between Officers and National Office staff in carrying out authorized responsibilities.

8.4 Officer Coordination and Leadership Transition

Officers shall communicate and work collaboratively to support coordinated governance leadership, prepare for Board business, address time-sensitive matters, and promote continuity.

Outgoing Officers are expected to support an orderly transition by providing their successors with relevant Association records, historical context, pending matters, deadlines, commitments, and other information necessary to assume the responsibilities of office.

Association records, correspondence, documents, and work products created or maintained in an official capacity remain the property of NAAHP and shall be transferred to the Association or the incoming Officer at the conclusion of service.

8.5 Related Documents

- NAAHP Bylaws
- Section 7, Board of Directors (p. 23)
- Section 9, Executive Committee (p. 30)
- Section 10, Finance Committee (p. 33)
- Section 11, Nominating Committee (p. 37)
- Section 12, Executive Director (p. 40)
- Section 15, Nominations and Appointments (p. 54)

9. Executive Committee

The Executive Committee is a committee of the Board of Directors that supports timely governance and decision-making between meetings of the full Board.

The Executive Committee reviews non-financial governance and organizational matters brought forward for consideration. It may act on matters within the authority provided by the Bylaws, this Manual, or the Board. Matters requiring full Board approval are referred to the Board of Directors.

9.1 Purpose

The Executive Committee helps the Board conduct necessary business between quarterly Board meetings, provides coordinated governance leadership, and supports the effective flow of matters requiring review, action, or referral.

The Executive Committee does not replace the Board of Directors. It acts only within its established or delegated authority and remains accountable to the Board.

9.2 Composition

The composition of the Executive Committee is established by the NAAHP Bylaws.

The Executive Director participates in Executive Committee meetings as the Association's chief executive and primary operational advisor, but does not vote unless otherwise provided by the Bylaws.

9.3 Responsibilities

The Executive Committee is responsible for:

- Reviewing non-financial governance and organizational matters brought forward between meetings of the Board.
- Acting on matters within its authority.
- Determining whether a matter requires review or approval by the full Board.
- Referring matters outside its authority to the Board of Directors.
- Supporting the preparation and coordination of Board business.
- Addressing time-sensitive governance matters when waiting for the next regularly scheduled Board meeting would not be practical.
- Providing guidance to the Executive Director on matters within the committee's governance responsibilities.
- Supporting leadership continuity and coordinated communication among the Officers, Board, and Executive Director.
- Reporting its actions and recommendations to the Board.

- Financial matters are ordinarily reviewed through the Finance Committee before being acted upon or referred to the Board.

9.4 Authority

The Executive Committee may take action on behalf of the Board when authorized by the Bylaws, this Manual, a Board-approved policy, or a specific delegation from the Board.

The Executive Committee may not:

- Amend the Articles of Incorporation or Bylaws.
- Exercise authority reserved by law or the Bylaws to the full Board or membership.
- Reverse or materially alter a decision of the Board without Board approval.
- Adopt a policy outside the authority delegated to it.
- Direct National Office staff or manage the Association's day-to-day operations.
- Take action on a matter that the committee determines warrants full Board review.

When the Executive Committee cannot act on a matter within its authority, or determines that broader Board deliberation is appropriate, the matter shall be scheduled for consideration by the Board of Directors.

9.5 Meetings and Decision-Making

The Executive Committee ordinarily meets monthly and may meet more frequently when necessary.

The committee reviews matters presented for consideration, determines whether action is authorized, and either:

- Approves or otherwise acts on the matter within its authority;
- Requests additional information or further review;
- Refers the matter to another appropriate committee; or
- Schedules the matter for review by the Board of Directors.

Meeting, quorum, voting, and notice requirements are governed by the Bylaws and applicable Board policy.

9.6 Relationship with the Board of Directors

The Executive Committee is accountable to the Board of Directors.

Actions taken by the Executive Committee between Board meetings shall be documented and reported to the Board. Significant decisions, recommendations, and matters awaiting Board action should be included in regular Board reporting or placed on an upcoming Board agenda.

The Board retains ultimate governance authority and may review, affirm, modify, or reverse Executive Committee action to the extent permitted by law and the Bylaws.

9.7 Relationship with the Executive Director

The Executive Director advises the Executive Committee, provides relevant operational information, and implements authorized decisions.

The Executive Committee provides governance direction but does not supervise National Office staff or manage day-to-day operations. Requests for staff support or operational action are coordinated through the Executive Director.

9.8 Related Documents

- NAAHP Bylaws
- Section 7, Board of Directors (p. 23)
- Section 8, Officers (p. 26)
- Section 10, Finance Committee (p. 33)
- Section 11, Nominating Committee (p. 37)
- Section 12, Executive Director (p. 40)
- Section 14, Board Operations (p. 49)

10. Finance Committee

The Finance Committee is a committee of the Board of Directors that supports the Board in carrying out its fiduciary responsibilities and provides financial oversight between meetings of the full Board.

The Finance Committee reviews the Association's financial condition, budget, financial policies, investments, internal controls, and significant financial risks. It may act on financial matters within the authority provided by the Bylaws, this Manual, or the Board. Matters requiring full Board approval are referred to the Board of Directors.

10.1 Purpose

The Finance Committee serves as the Board's principal committee for financial oversight, stewardship, and planning. It helps ensure that the Association's financial resources are managed responsibly and that financial decisions support NAAHP's mission, strategic priorities, and long-term sustainability.

The Finance Committee does not replace the Board of Directors. It acts only within its established or delegated authority and remains accountable to the Board.

10.2 Composition

The composition of the Finance Committee is established by the NAAHP Bylaws.

The Executive Director participates in Finance Committee meetings as the Association's chief executive and provides financial, operational, and administrative information necessary for informed oversight and decision-making.

10.3 Responsibilities

The Finance Committee is responsible for:

- Reviewing the Association's financial condition, performance, and long-term financial sustainability.
- Reviewing periodic financial statements, budget reports, cash position, investments, reserves, and material financial variances.
- Working with the Executive Director and Treasurer to develop and recommend the annual operating budget to the Board.
- Reviewing significant financial proposals before determining whether Board action is required.
- Reviewing and recommending financial policies and amendments to existing financial policies.
- Monitoring compliance with Board-approved financial policies and internal controls.
- Overseeing the Association's annual independent audit and any other financial examination authorized by the Board.
- Reviewing significant financial risks, obligations, commitments, and transactions.
- Reviewing investments and exercising any investment authority delegated by the Board.

- Referring significant governance or non-financial matters to the Executive Committee or Board, as appropriate.
- Reporting its actions and recommendations to the Board.

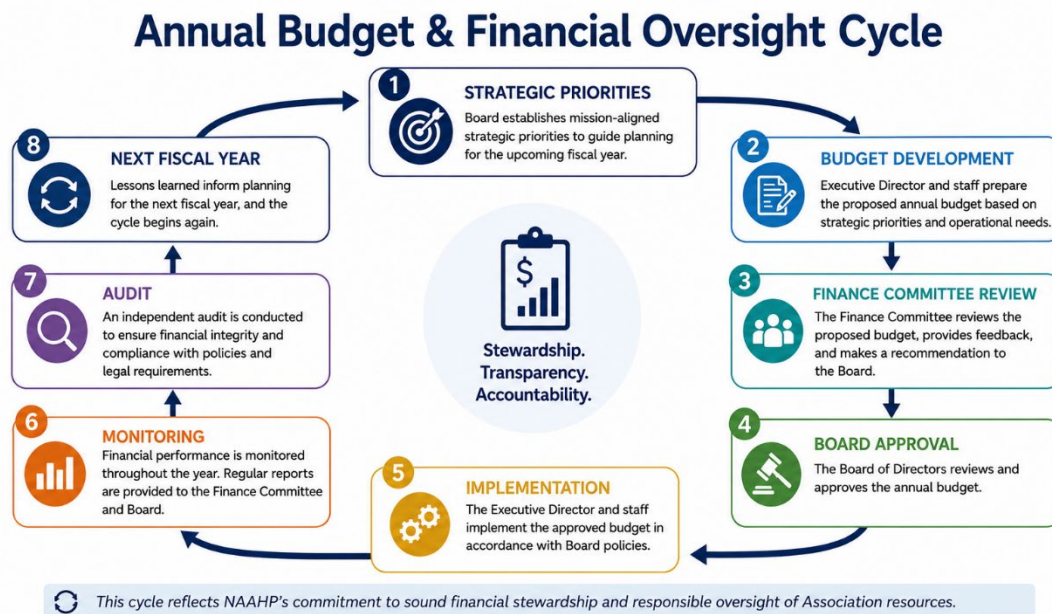


Figure: Annual Budget Oversight Cycle

10.4 Authority

The Finance Committee may take action on financial matters when authorized by the Bylaws, this Manual, a Board-approved policy, or a specific delegation from the Board.

Unless specifically authorized, the Finance Committee shall not:

- Approve the annual operating budget.
- Adopt or rescind Board policy.
- Authorize expenditures beyond its delegated authority.
- Enter into contracts or otherwise bind the Association.
- Direct the Association's routine financial operations.
- Supervise National Office staff.
- Exercise authority reserved to the Board by applicable law, the Articles of Incorporation, or the Bylaws.

When the Finance Committee cannot act on a financial matter within its authority, or determines that broader Board deliberation is appropriate, the matter shall be scheduled for consideration by the Board of Directors.

10.5 Budget Development and Financial Oversight

The Executive Director prepares the proposed annual budget with support from appropriate National Office staff and in collaboration with the Treasurer and Finance Committee.

The Finance Committee reviews the proposed budget, evaluates its alignment with the Association's mission, strategic priorities, anticipated resources, obligations, and financial condition, and recommends a budget to the Board for approval.

Following Board approval, the Executive Director administers the budget within Board-approved policy and delegated authority.

Throughout the fiscal year, the Finance Committee monitors financial performance and advises the Board regarding significant variances, emerging risks, or circumstances that may warrant corrective action or future Board consideration.

10.6 Meetings and Decision-Making

The Finance Committee ordinarily meets monthly and may meet more frequently when necessary.

The committee reviews financial matters presented for consideration and either:

- Approves or otherwise acts on the matter within its delegated authority;
- Requests additional financial information or analysis;
- Refers the matter to the Executive Committee when broader governance issues are involved; or
- Schedules the matter for consideration by the Board of Directors.

Meeting, quorum, voting, and notice requirements are governed by the Bylaws and applicable Board policy.

10.7 Relationship with the Board of Directors

The Finance Committee is accountable to the Board of Directors.

Actions taken by the Finance Committee between Board meetings shall be documented and reported to the Board. Significant financial decisions, recommendations, and matters requiring Board approval should be included in regular Board reporting or placed on an upcoming Board agenda.

The Board retains ultimate fiduciary responsibility for the Association's financial stewardship.

10.8 Relationship with the Executive Director

The Executive Director advises the Finance Committee by providing financial information, budget recommendations, operational analysis, and other information necessary for informed decision-making.

The Finance Committee provides governance oversight and financial guidance but does not manage the Association's day-to-day financial operations. Requests involving staff support or financial administration are coordinated through the Executive Director.

10.9 Related Documents

- NAAHP Bylaws
- Section 7, Board of Directors (p. 23)
- Section 8, Officers (p. 26)
- Section 9, Executive Committee (p. 30)
- Section 12, Executive Director (p. 40)
- Section 22, Financial Management (p. 75)

11. Nominating Committee

The Nominating Committee is a committee of the Board of Directors responsible for supporting leadership succession, identifying qualified leadership candidates, and recommending individuals for elected and appointed leadership positions assigned to the Committee by the Bylaws or the Board.

The Committee helps ensure that NAAHP maintains capable, engaged, and sustainable leadership by cultivating future leaders, evaluating organizational leadership needs, and supporting thoughtful leadership transitions.

11.1 Purpose

The Nominating Committee serves as the Board's principal committee for leadership recruitment, succession planning, and leadership recommendations.

The Committee recommends candidates for leadership positions within its assigned responsibilities but does not independently elect or appoint Association leaders.

11.2 Composition

The composition of the Nominating Committee is established by the NAAHP Bylaws.

Members of the Nominating Committee also serve on the Executive Committee as provided by the Bylaws. Although membership may overlap, each committee fulfills distinct responsibilities and exercises separate authority.

11.3 Responsibilities

The Nominating Committee is responsible for:

- Identifying current and future leadership needs.
- Developing and maintaining an ongoing leadership succession process.
- Identifying, recruiting, and evaluating qualified leadership candidates.
- Reviewing nominations for leadership positions assigned to the Committee.
- Assessing candidates' qualifications, experience, readiness, and ability to serve.
- Recommending qualified candidates to the Board for election or appointment, as applicable.
- Encouraging volunteer engagement and leadership development throughout the Association.
- Supporting orderly leadership transitions.
- Recommending improvements to leadership recruitment, nomination, and succession practices.
- Performing other responsibilities delegated by the Board.

11.4 Authority

The Nominating Committee exercises only the authority established by the Bylaws or delegated by the Board.

The Committee may identify, evaluate, and recommend candidates but may not independently elect, appoint, or remove Association leaders unless expressly authorized by the Bylaws or the Board.

The Committee shall conduct its work fairly, objectively, confidentially, and in the best interests of the Association.

11.5 Relationship with the Board of Directors

The Nominating Committee advises the Board regarding leadership succession and leadership recommendations.

The Committee shall provide sufficient information to support informed Board decision-making. Final authority for elections and appointments remains with the Board, except as otherwise provided in the Bylaws.

11.6 Relationship with the Executive Director

The Executive Director supports the Committee by providing organizational information, leadership records, volunteer service history, administrative support, and insight into organizational needs.

The Executive Director supports but does not direct the Committee's recommendations, nor does the Executive Director independently determine leadership appointments.

11.7 Leadership Development and Succession

Leadership development is a continuous responsibility rather than an activity performed only when vacancies occur.

The Committee should help maintain a strong leadership pipeline by:

- Identifying members with leadership potential.
- Encouraging meaningful volunteer participation.
- Promoting opportunities for increasing responsibility.
- Planning for anticipated leadership transitions.
- Supporting continuity and preserving institutional knowledge.

The Committee's role in leadership recruitment and candidate evaluation is one component of the Association's overall volunteer leadership process. Additional information regarding volunteer

recruitment, applications, appointments, onboarding, and leadership transitions is provided in Part III, Section 21. (p. 70)

11.8 Meetings and Decision-Making

The Nominating Committee meets as necessary to fulfill its responsibilities.

Meeting procedures, quorum, voting, and notice requirements are governed by the Bylaws and applicable Board policy.

The Committee's recommendations shall be presented to the Board for consideration.

11.9 Related Documents

- NAAHP Bylaws
- Section 7, Board of Directors (p. 23)
- Section 8, Officers (p. 26)
- Section 9, Executive Committee (p. 30)
- Section 12, Executive Director (p. 40)
- Section 15, Nominations and Appointments (p. 54)
- Section 21, Volunteer Engagement (p. 70)
- Section 32.2, Conflict of Interest Policy and Disclosure (p. 105)
- Section 32.7, Confidentiality Agreement (p. 105)

12. Executive Director

12.1 Purpose

The Executive Director serves as NAAHP's chief executive employee and is responsible for the effective management and administration of the Association.

The Board of Directors delegates operational authority to the Executive Director to manage NAAHP within the Bylaws, Board-approved policies, approved budget, strategic direction, and other parameters established by the Board.

The Executive Director is accountable to the Board as a whole. The Executive Director's employment, compensation, evaluation, and termination are governed by the Board and applicable employment agreements and policies.

12.2 Responsibilities

The Executive Director translates the Board's direction into effective organizational action.

The Executive Director is responsible for:

- Implementing the policies, priorities, and strategic direction established by the Board.
- Managing the Association's programs, services, finances, staff, contracts, systems, and daily operations.
- Developing and recommending plans, budgets, policies, and other matters requiring Board consideration.
- Providing the Board with timely, accurate, and relevant information necessary for informed governance and decision-making.
- Monitoring organizational performance and reporting progress, challenges, risks, and emerging opportunities to the Board.
- Managing the Association's financial resources within the approved budget and applicable financial policies.
- Establishing and maintaining appropriate administrative systems, internal controls, and operational procedures.
- Ensuring that the Association complies with applicable legal, regulatory, contractual, and reporting requirements.
- Recruiting, supervising, evaluating, developing, and, when necessary, separating National Office staff.
- Supporting the effective work of Officers, committees, task forces, working groups, and other volunteer bodies.
- Maintaining productive relationships with members, partner organizations, vendors, professional associations, and other stakeholders.
- Protecting the Association's assets, reputation, confidential information, and institutional knowledge.
- Performing other responsibilities assigned by the Board.

The Executive Director may take reasonable and necessary action to manage the Association when a matter falls within delegated authority and is not otherwise addressed by Board-approved policy.

12.3 Relationship with the Board of Directors

The Board governs the Association. The Executive Director manages the Association.

The Board establishes policy, strategic direction, financial parameters, and expected organizational outcomes. The Executive Director determines how best to achieve those outcomes by administering NAAHP's operations, resources, staff, programs, and services.

The Executive Director is accountable to the Board of Directors and works closely with the Executive Committee to carry out the Association's governance direction. Individual Directors may not independently direct the Executive Director, assign operational work, or modify organizational priorities. Direction outside of routine communication shall come through formal action of the Board, the Executive Committee acting within its delegated authority, or other authority expressly delegated by the Board.

The Executive Director shall:

- Keep the Board appropriately informed.
- Identify matters requiring Board action or attention.
- Provide candid professional advice and recommendations.
- Disclose significant risks, compliance concerns, financial issues, or operational challenges.
- Support the Board's ability to fulfill its fiduciary responsibilities.
- Implement properly authorized Board decisions.

The Executive Director may respectfully question or seek clarification of Board direction when doing so supports informed decision-making, legal compliance, responsible stewardship, or the interests of the Association.

12.4 Relationship with the President and Officers

The Executive Director works closely with the President to support effective governance, Board preparation, communication, and leadership continuity.

The President serves as the principal liaison between the Board and the Executive Director on governance matters. This relationship does not authorize the President to independently supervise the Executive Director, alter Board-approved policy, or direct the Association's operations unless the Board has expressly delegated that authority.

The Executive Director supports Officers in carrying out their authorized governance responsibilities and provides information reasonably necessary for their work.

Officers and the Executive Director are expected to maintain open communication, respect established roles, and avoid actions that create conflicting direction or unclear accountability.

12.5 Operational Authority

Within the authority delegated by the Board, the Executive Director may:

- Establish administrative procedures and operational practices.
- Allocate staff and organizational resources.
- Approve expenditures within the adopted budget and applicable financial requirements.
- Negotiate and execute contracts within authorized limits.
- Manage programs, services, events, publications, technology, membership operations, and other Association activities.
- Engage consultants, vendors, and professional service providers.
- Respond to operational risks, emergencies, and time-sensitive matters.
- Represent the Association in routine business and professional matters.
- Take other actions reasonably necessary to carry out the Association's work.
- The Executive Director exercises professional judgment in carrying out responsibilities delegated by the Board. Unless specifically limited by law, the Bylaws, this Manual, Board-approved policy, or formal Board action, decisions regarding the methods, timing, staffing, and administration of the Association's operations are the responsibility of the Executive Director.

The Executive Director shall refer matters to the Board when they:

- Require the adoption or amendment of Board policy.
- Exceed approved financial or contractual authority.
- Materially alter the Association's strategic direction.
- Create significant legal, financial, reputational, or organizational risk.
- Involve the Executive Director's employment or compensation.
- Are otherwise reserved to the Board by law, the Bylaws, this Manual, or formal Board action.

Figure 12.1
Governance, Management & Operational Relationships

NAAHP operates through the partnership of governance leadership, professional management, and volunteer engagement.

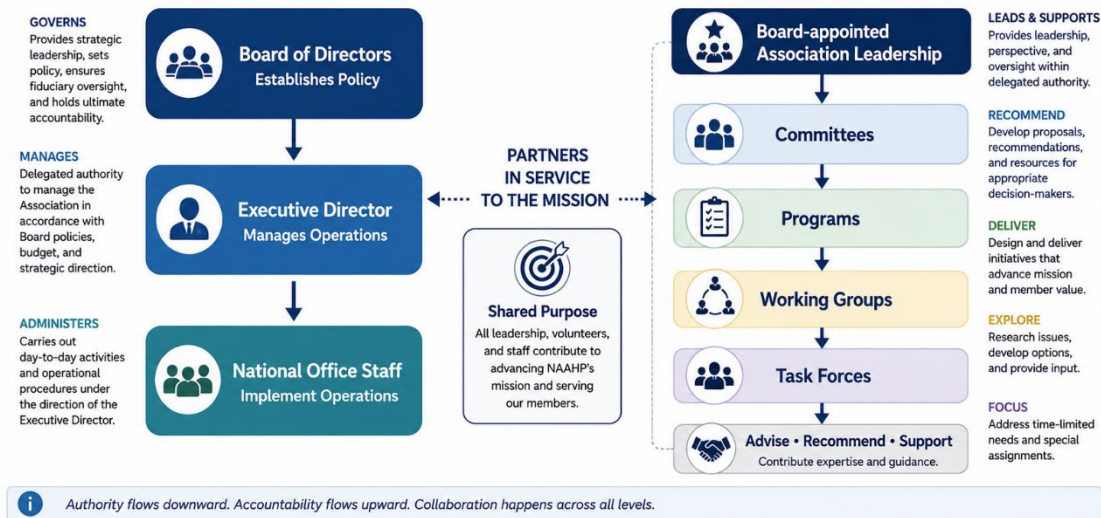


Figure 2.2 Governance, Management & Operational Relationships

12.6 Staff Leadership and Delegation

The Executive Director is responsible for the organization, supervision, development, and performance of National Office staff.

The Executive Director may establish and revise the National Office's organizational structure within the approved budget and in accordance with any parameters established by the Board.

The Executive Director may delegate operational authority and responsibilities to staff, consultants, or other authorized individuals while retaining overall accountability for the Association's work.

National Office staff report through the organizational structure established by the Executive Director. Board members, Officers, committees, and volunteers shall not supervise staff or assign work directly unless authorized by the Executive Director or the Board.

The Executive Director shall promote a professional workplace characterized by clear expectations, accountability, collaboration, professional development, fairness, and respect.

12.7 Support of Committees and Volunteers

The Executive Director supports the Association's volunteer structure by helping committees, task forces, working groups, and other volunteer bodies understand their responsibilities, authority, and relationships with the Board and National Office.

The Executive Director may assign staff support and organizational resources based on strategic priorities, available capacity, and the approved budget.

Committees and volunteers may develop recommendations, proposals, programs, or other work within their assigned responsibilities. They may not direct National Office staff, commit Association resources, enter into agreements, or implement decisions without appropriate authorization.

Additional information about volunteer recruitment, appointments, onboarding, leadership transitions, and volunteer operations is provided in Part III, including Section 21. (p. 70)

12.8 Professional Standards

The Executive Director is expected to carry out the responsibilities of the position with:

- Integrity and sound judgment.
- Commitment to NAAHP's mission.
- Responsible financial and organizational stewardship.
- Transparency and accountability.
- Appropriate confidentiality.
- Respect for the Board's governing authority.
- Fairness and professionalism.
- Responsiveness to members and stakeholders.
- Attention to the Association's long-term sustainability.

The Executive Director shall avoid or appropriately manage actual, potential, or perceived conflicts of interest and comply with all applicable ethics, confidentiality, disclosure, and conduct requirements.

12.9 Performance Evaluation and Support

The Board shall periodically evaluate the Executive Director's performance using criteria established by the Board.

The evaluation should consider, as appropriate:

- Progress toward strategic and organizational goals.
- Implementation of Board policies and priorities.
- Financial stewardship.
- Staff leadership and organizational effectiveness.
- Risk management and compliance.
- Relationships with the Board, members, partners, and stakeholders.
- The Association's overall condition and sustainability.

The Board shall provide the Executive Director with clear expectations, constructive feedback, appropriate support, and the resources reasonably necessary to carry out the responsibilities of the position.

The Executive Director's evaluation shall be coordinated through the process established by the Board and administered by the Executive Committee or another body designated by the Board.

12.10 Related Documents

- NAAHP Bylaws
- Section 3, Governance Philosophy (p. 13)
- Section 4, Governing Authority and Delegation (p. 15)
- Section 7, Board of Directors (p. 23)
- Section 8, Officers (p. 26)
- Section 9, Executive Committee (p. 30)
- Section 10, Finance Committee (p. 33)
- Section 13, Association Leadership (p. 46)
- Section 21, Volunteer Engagement (p. 70)

13. Association Leadership

13.1 Purpose

Association Leadership consists of volunteer leaders appointed or elected to provide organizational leadership beyond the Board of Directors. These leaders help advance the Association's mission by supporting Board-approved priorities, guiding Association initiatives, engaging members, and working collaboratively with the Executive Director, National Office staff, and volunteers.

Association Leadership complements, but does not replace, the governance responsibilities of the Board of Directors or the operational responsibilities of the Executive Director.

13.2 Composition

Association Leadership includes leadership positions established by the Board or the Bylaws to provide direction for the Association's programs, committees, and other organizational initiatives.

Association Leadership may include:

- Program Coordinators
- Action Committee Chairs
- Other leadership positions established or recognized by the Board

The specific leadership positions serving the Association may change over time as organizational needs evolve.

Eligibility for Association Leadership is not categorically restricted by membership category. Any qualifications established by the Bylaws, this Manual, or Board action for a specific position continue to apply.

13.3 Responsibilities

Collectively, Association Leadership is responsible for:

- Supporting the Association's mission, strategic priorities, and Board-approved initiatives.
- Providing leadership within assigned areas of responsibility.
- Working collaboratively with the Executive Director, National Office staff, Board leaders, and volunteers.
- Encouraging member engagement and volunteer participation.
- Promoting effective communication across the Association.
- Supporting leadership development and succession planning.
- Exercising sound judgment, professionalism, and responsible stewardship.

- Performing responsibilities assigned by the Board, the Executive Director, or the applicable governing documents.

13.4 Authority

Association Leadership exercises only the authority assigned through the Bylaws, this Manual, Board action, or authority delegated by the Executive Director.

Unless specifically authorized, Association Leadership may not:

- Establish Board policy.
- Commit Association resources.
- Execute contracts or other legal agreements.
- Direct National Office staff.
- Speak on behalf of the Association outside their assigned responsibilities.

The exercise of authority is reserved to the Board or the Executive Director.

13.5 Relationship with the Executive Director

Association Leadership works collaboratively with the Executive Director to advance the Association's mission and strategic priorities.

The Executive Director provides operational coordination, administrative support, organizational guidance, and staff resources necessary to support Association Leadership within available resources and established priorities.

Association Leadership provides volunteer leadership and subject-matter expertise. The Executive Director remains responsible for the administration and management of the Association's operations.

13.6 Leadership Expectations

Association leaders are expected to:

- Place the Association's mission above personal, institutional, regional, or professional interests.
- Act with integrity, professionalism, and respect.
- Collaborate constructively with volunteers, staff, and fellow leaders.
- Respect established governance and reporting relationships.
- Protect confidential information.
- Disclose and appropriately manage conflicts of interest.
- Support orderly leadership transitions and continuity.

13.7 Related Documents

- Section 3, Governance Philosophy (p. 13)
- Section 4, Governing Authority and Delegation (p. 15)
- Section 12, Executive Director (p. 40)
- Section 16, Organizational Structure (p. 57)
- Section 17, Action Committees (p. 60)
- Section 20, Association Programs (p. 68)
- Section 21, Volunteer Engagement (p. 70)

14. Board Operations

14.1 Purpose

Board operations provide the framework through which the Board of Directors fulfills its governance responsibilities. Through regular meetings and informed decision-making, the Board establishes strategic direction, exercises fiduciary oversight, adopts policy, monitors organizational performance, and acts in the best interests of the Association.

Board operations should promote transparency, accountability, thoughtful deliberation, and efficient use of the Board's time while maintaining a focus on NAAHP's mission and long-term sustainability.

14.2 Board Meetings

The Board conducts its business through meetings held in accordance with the NAAHP Bylaws.

The Board normally meets four times each year in March, June, September, and December. Special meetings may be called as authorized by the Bylaws when necessary to conduct the business of the Association.

Meeting schedules, notice requirements, quorum, voting procedures, and other procedural requirements are governed by the Bylaws.

14.3 Annual Governance Calendar

The Board should maintain an annual governance calendar identifying recurring governance responsibilities throughout the year.

Typical activities include:

- Strategic planning
- Budget review and approval
- Financial oversight
- Leadership elections and appointments
- Executive Director evaluation
- Committee and organizational reports
- Policy review
- Governance education
- Risk oversight
- Other recurring governance responsibilities

Maintaining an annual governance calendar promotes continuity, accountability, and effective governance.

14.4 Meeting Preparation

Effective governance begins before each meeting.

Directors are expected to:

- Review meeting materials before the meeting.
- Become familiar with agenda items requiring Board action.
- Request clarification before the meeting when appropriate.
- Disclose actual or potential conflicts of interest related to agenda items.
- Arrive prepared to participate in informed discussion and decision-making.

Meeting materials should be distributed sufficiently in advance to allow Directors adequate opportunity for review whenever practical.

14.5 Agenda Development

The President, in collaboration with the Executive Director and Executive Committee, develops Board meeting agendas.

Agendas should emphasize governance responsibilities and prioritize matters requiring Board deliberation and action while providing adequate time for discussion of strategic issues, financial oversight, organizational performance, and other significant matters.

14.6 Consent Agenda

Routine, recurring, or informational matters may be presented through a consent agenda to improve meeting efficiency.

Items appropriate for a consent agenda may include:

- Approval of previous meeting minutes.
- Routine committee reports.
- Informational reports.
- Administrative updates.
- Other non-controversial matters.

Any Director may request that an item be removed from the consent agenda for separate discussion before action is taken.

14.7 Conduct of Meetings

Board meetings should encourage respectful discussion, informed deliberation, and constructive decision-making.

Directors are expected to:

- Participate actively and professionally.
- Listen respectfully to differing viewpoints.
- Ask thoughtful questions.
- Focus the discussion on issues rather than individuals.

- Support an environment of constructive dialogue.
- Contribute to informed decision-making.
- Conduct themselves in a manner consistent with the Association's Code of Ethics and Conflict of Interest Policy.

The President is responsible for facilitating fair, orderly, and productive meetings while ensuring Directors have an appropriate opportunity to participate.

14.8 Executive Sessions

The Board may meet in executive session whenever confidential discussion is necessary.

Attendance is limited to Directors and other individuals specifically invited by the Board.

Executive session discussions and materials shall remain confidential except when disclosure is authorized by the Board or required by law.

Executive sessions may be appropriate for matters involving:

- Personnel matters.
- Legal matters.
- Executive Director evaluation.
- Confidential negotiations.
- Governance matters.
- Other sensitive issues requiring confidential discussion.

14.9 Virtual Participation

Board meetings may be conducted through approved remote communication methods consistent with the Bylaws and applicable law.

Directors participating remotely are expected to:

- Participate fully throughout the meeting.
- Maintain confidentiality.
- Minimize distractions.
- Ensure adequate technology for meaningful participation.
- Engage in discussion as though attending in person.

14.10 Board Decisions and Follow-Up

The Board strives to make decisions that advance the Association's mission, support its strategic priorities, and promote its long-term sustainability.

Following each meeting:

- Board actions shall be communicated to those responsible for implementation.
- Assignments should be documented and monitored.

- Meeting minutes shall accurately reflect Board actions.
- Committees and the Executive Director should report progress on assigned responsibilities.
- The Board should monitor the implementation of significant decisions.

Effective follow-up promotes accountability and helps ensure that Board decisions are successfully implemented.

14.11 Relationship with the Executive Director

The Executive Director supports the work of the Board by:

- Preparing meeting materials.
- Providing information necessary for informed governance.
- Advising the Board on operational matters.
- Implementing Board actions.
- Monitoring progress on Board priorities.
- Coordinating appropriate follow-up with National Office staff.

The Executive Director participates in Board meetings as provided by the Bylaws and at the direction of the Board, but does not assume the governance responsibilities reserved to the Board.

14.12 Related Documents

- NAAHP Bylaws
- Section 7, Board of Directors (p. 23)
- Section 8, Officers (p. 26)
- Section 9, Executive Committee (p. 30)
- Section 10, Finance Committee (p. 33)
- Section 12, Executive Director (p. 40)
- Section 27, Association Records and Information Management (p. 89)
- Section 32.2, Conflict of Interest Policy and Disclosure (p. 105)
- Section 32.7, Confidentiality Agreement (p. 105)



Figure 2.3 Annual Governance Calendar

15. Nominations and Appointments

15.1 Purpose

NAAHP fills leadership positions through nominations and appointments to ensure qualified, prepared individuals serve in leadership and volunteer roles.

This section establishes the framework for leadership nominations, appointments, vacancies, and succession. Volunteer recruitment, applications, onboarding, and participation are addressed in Section 21, Volunteer Engagement. (p. 70)

15.2 Officer Nominations

Officer nominations are coordinated by the Nominating Committee in accordance with the NAAHP Bylaws.

The Committee identifies and recommends qualified nominees based on experience, leadership needs, and the Association's long-term interests. The Board acts on nominations in accordance with the Bylaws.

Officer eligibility and succession are governed by the Bylaws. Membership category alone does not bar an otherwise eligible member from a Board position, elected office, or Association Leadership role.

15.3 Appointment Authority

Appointment authority varies depending on the position and responsibilities.

Unless otherwise provided by the Bylaws or Board action:

Position	Appointment Authority
Officers	Board of Directors following the nomination process
Action Committee Chairs	Board of Directors
Program Coordinators	Board of Directors
Other Association Leadership positions established by the Board	Board of Directors
Committee Members	Committee Chairs
Working Group Members	Authority establishing the Working Group
Task Force Members	Authority establishing the Task Force
Program Volunteers	Executive Director or delegated authority
Ambassadors and other volunteer positions	Ambassador Coordinator, Executive Director, or delegated authority, unless otherwise specified

The Board may establish or delegate appointment authority for additional leadership or volunteer positions as organizational needs evolve.

The process for recruiting, reviewing, and appointing volunteers is described in Part III, Section 21, Volunteer Engagement. (p. 70)

15.4 Vacancies

Leadership vacancies shall be filled by the authority responsible for the original nomination or appointment unless otherwise provided by the Bylaws or Board action.

When filling a vacancy, the responsible authority should consider:

- the responsibilities of the position;
- the remaining term of service;
- organizational continuity;
- the qualifications of prospective candidates; and
- the current needs of the Association.

Vacancies in Officer positions shall be addressed in accordance with the Bylaws.

15.5 Succession

Leadership succession is an ongoing responsibility shared by the Board, the Nominating Committee, the Executive Director, and Association Leadership.

NAAHP is committed to identifying and developing future leaders by encouraging volunteer engagement, providing opportunities for increasing responsibility, and supporting orderly leadership transitions.

Whenever practical, leadership transitions should be planned to promote continuity, preserve institutional knowledge, and ensure the uninterrupted conduct of Association business.

Additional information regarding leadership development, volunteer participation, onboarding, and transitions is provided in Part III, Section 21, Volunteer Engagement. (p. 70)

15.6 Related Documents

- NAAHP Bylaws
- Section 8, Officers (p. 26)
- Section 11, Nominating Committee (p. 37)
- Section 13, Association Leadership (p. 46)
- Section 21, Volunteer Engagement (p. 70)
- Section 27, Association Records and Information Management (p. 89)
- Section 32.2, Conflict of Interest Policy and Disclosure (p. 105)

PART III

Organizational Structure & Volunteer Engagement

How NAAHP organizes volunteer leadership, committees, temporary groups, programs, and opportunities for member service.

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◆ KEY PRINCIPLE

Committees and volunteer groups advance the Association’s work through clearly defined responsibilities and delegated authority.

16. Organizational Structure

16.1 Purpose

NAAHP accomplishes its mission through a collaborative organizational structure that combines governance, professional staff, and volunteer leadership.

The Association's work is carried out through Board-appointed leaders, National Office staff, Action Committees, Working Groups, Task Forces, Association Programs, and volunteers. Each serves a distinct role while working together to advance the Association's strategic priorities and provide value to members.

This section provides an overview of the Association's organization. Additional information about specific organizational bodies is provided throughout this Part.

16.2 Organizational Relationships

The Association's organizational structure is designed to provide clear governance, effective operational management, and meaningful opportunities for volunteer engagement.

The Board of Directors governs the Association by establishing policy, strategic direction, and organizational priorities.

The Executive Director manages the Association's operations and provides leadership for the National Office staff while supporting the work of the Board and volunteer leadership.

Board-appointed Association Leadership provides volunteer leadership for the Association's major functional areas and collaborates with the Executive Director and National Office staff.

Action Committees, Working Groups, Task Forces, and Association Programs carry out much of the Association's ongoing work through volunteer participation and staff support.

Together, these organizational components allow NAAHP to combine professional management with volunteer expertise in support of its mission.

16.3 Organizational Hierarchy

The Association's organizational relationships are illustrated below.



Figure 3.1 Organizational Relationships

16.4 Principles of Organizational Responsibility

To promote effective governance and operations, NAAHP follows several organizational principles:

- The Board establishes organizational policy and strategic direction.
- The Executive Director manages the Association's operations and National Office staff.
- Association Leadership provides volunteer leadership within assigned responsibilities.
- Committees, Working Groups, Task Forces, and Programs develop recommendations, complete assigned work, and support the Association's strategic priorities.
- Volunteers contribute through collaboration, professional expertise, and service.
- National Office staff provide administrative, operational, and professional support across the Association.

These roles are intended to complement one another while maintaining clear accountability and appropriate separation between governance and operations.

Organizational Evolution

NAAHP uses a flexible organizational structure that allows ideas and initiatives to develop over time. A Task Force may identify the need for further development and transition into a Working Group. A Working Group may create the infrastructure for a continuing initiative and recommend its establishment as an Association Program.

This progression is not required in every case. Organizational bodies may be created, continued, modified, or concluded based on the Association's needs, priorities, resources, and the authority responsible for the work.



Good ideas deserve a clear path. Strong ideas deserve staying power.

Figure 3.2 Evolution of Organizational Initiatives

16.5 Organizational Flexibility

NAAHP periodically establishes, modifies, consolidates, or discontinues organizational bodies to respond to changing member needs, strategic priorities, and available resources.

Unless otherwise established by the Bylaws or Board action, the Board may create or discontinue committees, programs, working groups, task forces, or other organizational structures as necessary to support the Association's mission.

The Executive Director may recommend organizational changes to improve operational effectiveness and the efficient use of Association resources.

17. Action Committees

17.1 Purpose

Action Committees are standing volunteer bodies established by the Board of Directors to support the Association's mission, strategic priorities, and ongoing work.

Each Action Committee serves as NAAHP's content expert group within its assigned area of responsibility. Through the knowledge and experience of its members, the Committee provides insight, professional perspective, recommendations, and support for relevant Association initiatives.

Action Committees also provide members with opportunities to contribute meaningfully to the Association's work. They operate within the authority assigned by the Board and work collaboratively with the Action Committee Coordinator, Executive Director, National Office staff, and other organizational bodies.

17.2 Responsibilities

Action Committees support NAAHP by providing subject matter expertise, volunteer leadership, and practical guidance within their assigned areas of responsibility.

An Action Committee may:

- Serve as the Association's primary source of content expertise within its assigned area.
- Monitor emerging issues, professional developments, and member needs.
- Advise the Board, Executive Director, and National Office staff on matters within the Committee's scope.
- Develop recommendations, resources, programs, and initiatives that support the Association's mission and strategic priorities.
- Complete projects and assignments approved by the Board or coordinated through the Executive Director.
- Collaborate with other Action Committees, Working Groups, Task Forces, and Association Programs when responsibilities overlap.
- Support meaningful volunteer participation and help identify opportunities for member involvement.
- Evaluate its work and recommend changes when needed.

Action Committees carry out their responsibilities within the authority, priorities, and resources established by the Association.

17.3 Authority

Action Committees operate under the authority of the Board of Directors and within the scope of responsibility assigned to them by the Association.

Action Committees are advisory in nature unless the Board has expressly delegated decision-making authority for a specific matter. Their primary role is to provide subject matter expertise, develop recommendations, and support the implementation of the Association's strategic priorities.

Action Committees may make recommendations to the Board, Executive Director, or other organizational bodies, but they may not:

- Establish Association policy.
- Commit Association funds or resources unless specifically authorized.
- Enter into agreements or obligations on behalf of the Association.
- Direct the work of National Office staff.
- Speak or act on behalf of the Association unless authorized to do so.

Action Committees exercise their responsibilities in collaboration with the Action Committee Coordinator, Executive Director, and National Office staff, consistent with the authority delegated by the Board.

17.4 Committee Leadership and Membership

Each Action Committee is led by a Committee Chair appointed by the Board of Directors as part of the Association's leadership structure. The Chair is responsible for providing leadership to the Committee, facilitating its work, and ensuring that committee activities align with the Association's mission, strategic priorities, and assigned responsibilities.

Prior service on an Action Committee is not required for appointment as an Action Committee Chair.

Committee Composition and Membership

Action Committees do not have prescribed membership numbers, regional quotas, or other required composition unless the Board of Directors establishes a specific requirement for a particular Committee.

Committee Chairs determine the composition of their Committees, in consultation with the Co-Chair when one is appointed, based on the Committee's charge, current work, needed expertise, member interest, and effective operation of the Committee. All NAAHP membership categories are eligible to serve on Action Committees and in committee leadership roles unless a specific qualification is established by the Bylaws or the Board of Directors.

NAAHP encourages Committee Chairs to seek broad participation and perspectives when developing Committee membership. Representation from each of NAAHP's regional associations is recommended when practical, but regional representation is not a requirement and vacancies should not be defined or maintained solely by region.

Committee Chairs have final responsibility for selecting Committee members. When a Committee seeks additional volunteers through an open recruitment process, the Chair should use NAAHP's established Volunteer Engagement process described in Section 21, Volunteer Engagement.

The Committee Chair is responsible for:

- Providing leadership and direction for the Committee's work.
- Establishing goals and priorities consistent with the Committee's purpose.
- Facilitating productive meetings and encouraging meaningful member participation.
- Assigning work and coordinating Committee activities.
- Working collaboratively with the Action Committee Coordinator, Executive Director, National Office staff, and other Association leaders.
- Communicating Committee accomplishments, recommendations, and needs as appropriate.
- Supporting the recruitment, engagement, and development of Committee members.

Committee Chairs lead the work of their respective Committees but do not independently establish Association policy, commit Association resources, direct National Office staff, or exercise authority beyond that delegated by the Board.

Committee members contribute their expertise, participate actively in Committee activities, complete assigned work, and support the Committee in fulfilling its responsibilities on behalf of the Association.

17.5 Action Committee Coordinator

The Action Committee Coordinator is the Program Coordinator appointed by the Board and is responsible for supporting and coordinating NAAHP's Action Committee structure.

Working collaboratively with Committee Chairs, the Executive Director, and National Office staff, the Action Committee Coordinator promotes communication, collaboration, consistency, and the effective operation of the Association's Action Committees.

The Action Committee Coordinator may:

- Support Committee Chairs and Co-Chairs in carrying out their responsibilities.
- Promote communication and collaboration among Action Committees.
- Encourage the sharing of information, resources, and effective practices across committees.
- Help identify opportunities for cross-committee initiatives and collaboration.
- Support leadership development and succession planning within the Action Committee structure.
- Serve as a resource to Committee leaders regarding committee operations, organizational practices, and available resources.
- Communicate committee activities, opportunities, and emerging needs to the Executive Director and National Office staff, as appropriate.
- Perform other responsibilities assigned by the Board or Executive Director.

The Action Committee Coordinator serves in a coordinating and leadership role and does not appoint Committee Chairs or Committee members, supervise National Office staff, or exercise authority beyond that delegated by the Board or Executive Director.

17.6 Relationship with the Executive Director and National Office

Action Committees work in partnership with the Executive Director and National Office staff to advance the Association's mission and strategic priorities.

The Executive Director is responsible for the operational management of the Association and provides administrative oversight, guidance, and support to Action Committees. National Office staff assist with committee operations, communications, project implementation, and other administrative functions within their assigned responsibilities.

Action Committees provide volunteer leadership and subject matter expertise, while the Executive Director and National Office staff provide operational management and administrative support. This collaborative relationship enables the Association to effectively carry out its programs, services, and strategic initiatives.

Committee recommendations are communicated through the Association's established governance and administrative processes and are considered by the appropriate organizational body based on the nature of the recommendation.

17.7 Establishment and Review

Action Committees are established, modified, combined, or discontinued by the Board of Directors as necessary to support the Association's mission, strategic priorities, and operational needs.

The Board periodically reviews the Action Committee structure to ensure it remains effective, appropriately aligned with the Association's priorities, and responsive to the evolving needs of the profession and the membership.

The Executive Director, Action Committee Coordinator, Committee Chairs, and other Association leaders may recommend changes to the Action Committee structure for Board consideration. When appropriate, recommendations should promote organizational effectiveness, encourage collaboration, and avoid unnecessary duplication of responsibilities. The Association may adapt the Action Committee structure over time to address changing strategic priorities, emerging professional issues, member needs, and organizational capacity.

18. Task Forces

18.1 Purpose

Task Forces are short-term, ad hoc volunteer groups established to examine a specific issue, opportunity, challenge, or assignment requiring focused study and analysis.

Task Forces provide the Association with a flexible mechanism for researching emerging topics, evaluating alternatives, gathering stakeholder input, and developing informed recommendations. Unlike Action Committees, Task Forces do not have continuing responsibilities and are created to accomplish a defined objective within an established timeframe.

The primary outcome of a Task Force is a findings report that documents its work, summarizes observations and recommendations, and provides guidance for consideration by the appropriate Association leadership.

18.2 Responsibilities

Task Forces support the Association by conducting focused research and developing informed recommendations within their assigned scope.

A Task Force may:

- Research assigned issues or topics.
- Gather information and relevant stakeholder perspectives.
- Evaluate options, opportunities, and potential approaches.
- Develop findings and recommendations.
- Prepare and submit a findings report.
- Present findings to the Board, Executive Director, Action Committee, or other organizational body, as appropriate.
- Complete additional assignments consistent with the Task Force's purpose.

Task Forces perform only the responsibilities assigned to them and do not assume the continuing responsibilities of an Action Committee or Working Group.

18.3 Authority

Task Forces operate under the authority of the Board of Directors or the Executive Director, as delegated by the Board, and within the scope established for the Task Force.

Task Forces are advisory in nature and exist to conduct research, develop findings, and make recommendations. They do not establish Association policy or implement ongoing programs unless specifically authorized.

Task Forces may not:

- Establish Association policy.
- Commit Association funds or resources unless specifically authorized.

- Enter into agreements or obligations on behalf of the Association.
- Direct the work of National Office staff.
- Speak or act on behalf of the Association unless authorized to do so.

18.4 Leadership and Membership

Each Task Force is led by a **Task Force Lead** appointed by the authority establishing the Task Force.

The Task Force Lead is responsible for organizing the Task Force's work, facilitating meetings and discussions, coordinating the development of the findings report, and ensuring the Task Force completes its assigned responsibilities.

Task Force Leads provide project leadership but are not considered Association Leadership solely by virtue of serving in that role.

Task Force members are selected through NAAHP's Volunteer Engagement process or by other methods authorized for the specific assignment. Membership should reflect the knowledge, experience, and perspectives needed to evaluate the assigned issue or topic effectively.

The Association's volunteer recruitment, application, appointment, onboarding, and transition processes are described in Section 21, Volunteer Engagement. (p. 70)

18.5 Establishment, Duration, and Transition

Task Forces may be established, modified, or concluded by the Board of Directors or by the Executive Director when acting within delegated authority.

Each Task Force should have a clearly defined purpose, scope, expected outcomes, and anticipated timeframe. Unless otherwise authorized, Task Forces are intended to complete a specific assignment rather than serve as continuing organizational bodies.

Upon completion of its work, a Task Force submits its findings report to the appropriate Association leadership for consideration.

When a Task Force identifies the need for continued development, implementation, or ongoing organizational support, its findings may include a recommendation to establish a Working Group, create another appropriate organizational body, or conclude the initiative.

19. Working Groups

19.1 Purpose

Working Groups are collaborative volunteer bodies established to develop the infrastructure, resources, and operational framework needed to advance a defined Association initiative.

A Working Group may be created in response to a Task Force's findings or when the Association identifies an initiative that requires focused development before it can become an ongoing program. Working Groups move an idea from research and recommendation toward practical implementation.

Unlike Task Forces, which primarily study an issue and produce findings, Working Groups focus on determining how an initiative should operate. Their work may include developing models, standards, processes, resources, pilot activities, and recommendations for sustainable implementation.

19.2 Responsibilities

Working Groups support the Association by designing, testing, and refining initiatives within their assigned scope.

A Working Group may:

- Review relevant findings, recommendations, and organizational needs.
- Develop the structure and operating framework for an initiative.
- Create standards, resources, guidance, or implementation plans.
- Identify staffing, volunteer, financial, technological, and administrative needs.
- Conduct pilot activities or test proposed approaches when authorized.
- Evaluate results and recommend improvements.
- Coordinate with Action Committees, Task Forces, Association Programs, the Executive Director, and National Office staff.
- Recommend whether an initiative should conclude, continue in development, or be established as an Association Program.

Working Groups perform only the responsibilities assigned to them and do not independently establish continuing Association programs.

19.3 Authority

Working Groups operate under the authority of the Board of Directors or the Executive Director, as delegated by the Board, and within the scope established for the Working Group.

Working Groups may develop infrastructure, conduct authorized pilot activities, and make recommendations. They may not:

- Establish Association policy.
- Create or designate an Association Program without the required approval.

- Commit Association funds or resources unless specifically authorized.
- Enter into agreements or obligations on behalf of the Association.
- Direct the work of National Office staff.
- Speak or act on behalf of the Association unless authorized to do so.

Any recommendation to establish an ongoing Association Program is considered through the Association's established approval and resource-allocation processes.

19.4 Leadership and Membership

Each Working Group is led by a Working Group Chair or Co-Chairs appointed by the Board of Directors as part of Association Leadership.

The Chair(s) are responsible for organizing the Working Group's activities, facilitating its work, coordinating with the Executive Director and National Office staff, and ensuring that the Group fulfills its assigned purpose.

Working Group members are selected through NAAHP's Volunteer Engagement process or by another method authorized for the specific initiative. Membership should reflect the expertise, experience, perspectives, and implementation needs relevant to the Working Group's assignment.

The Association's volunteer recruitment, selection, onboarding, engagement, and transition processes are described in Section 21, Volunteer Engagement. (p. 70)

Working Group leaders and members do not exercise authority beyond that delegated by the Board or Executive Director.

19.5 Establishment, Review, and Transition

Working Groups may be established, modified, or concluded by the Board of Directors or by the Executive Director when acting within delegated authority.

Each Working Group should have a clearly defined purpose, scope, expected outcomes, and review process. Because Working Groups are developmental bodies, their continued value and progress should be reviewed periodically.

After its work, a Working Group may recommend that:

- The initiative concludes.
- Additional development or testing continues.
- The work transitions to another organizational body.
- The initiative will be established as an Association Program.

A Working Group does not automatically become an Association Program. The appropriate approving authority determines whether the initiative has demonstrated sufficient value, sustainability, organizational capacity, and alignment with NAAHP's mission and priorities to warrant continuing program status.

20. Association Programs

20.1 Purpose

Association Programs are Board-approved, ongoing initiatives established to advance NAAHP's mission, strategic priorities, and member value. They represent the Association's continuing commitment to delivering programs, services, resources, and engagement opportunities that support the professional development of members and advance the health professions advising community.

Unlike Task Forces and Working Groups, which are established to study or develop an initiative, Association Programs provide sustained value through continuing operations, volunteer leadership, and National Office support.

20.2 Current Association Programs

As of the adoption of this Manual, NAAHP's Association Programs include:

- NAAHP-Ed
- NAAHP-Leads
- New Advisor Development Program
- Ambassador Program

The Board of Directors may establish additional Association Programs or modify existing programs as the Association's needs and strategic priorities evolve.

Additional information regarding the purpose, structure, and operation of individual Association Programs may be maintained in Board-approved policies, program charters, or administrative procedures, as appropriate.

20.3 Authority and Responsibility

Association Programs operate under the authority of the Board of Directors and within the strategic direction, policies, and budget established by the Board.

The Executive Director is responsible for the operational management and administration of Association Programs and may assign responsibility for program coordination to National Office staff, Program Coordinators, or other volunteers, as appropriate.

Program Coordinators provide leadership and coordination for their assigned programs while working collaboratively with volunteers, Action Committees, the Executive Director, and National Office staff. Program Coordinators do not exercise authority beyond that delegated by the Board or Executive Director.

Association Programs may engage volunteers through NAAHP's Volunteer Engagement process. Volunteer recruitment, appointment, onboarding, and transition are described in Section 21, Volunteer Engagement. (p. 70)

20.4 Program Development and Transition

Association Programs may originate through the work of a Task Force, Working Group, Action Committee, or other organizational initiative. Recommendations to establish a new Association Program should demonstrate a continuing organizational need, alignment with the Association's mission and strategic priorities, and the capacity for long-term sustainability.

The establishment of an Association Program requires approval through the Association's established governance processes and does not occur automatically based on the recommendation of another organizational body.

20.5 Review and Sustainability

Association Programs should be reviewed periodically to ensure they continue to support the Association's mission, strategic priorities, and members' needs.

Program reviews may consider:

- Alignment with the Association's mission and strategic priorities.
- Member participation, engagement, and value.
- Achievement of intended outcomes.
- Organizational capacity and available resources.
- Opportunities for improvement, expansion, transition, or conclusion.

Based on these reviews, the Board of Directors may continue, modify, suspend, or discontinue an Association Program as appropriate.

21. Volunteer Engagement

21.1 Purpose

Volunteers are essential to NAAHP's ability to fulfill its mission and serve its members. The Association is committed to providing meaningful volunteer opportunities that support its strategic priorities while encouraging professional growth, leadership development, and member engagement.

NAAHP's Volunteer Engagement process provides a consistent framework for identifying volunteer needs, recruiting and selecting volunteers, supporting their success, and recognizing their contributions. The process is designed to align volunteer opportunities with the Association's organizational needs while providing members with clear pathways to become involved.

21.2 Volunteer Ecosystem

NAAHP maintains a Volunteer Ecosystem that provides a structured, transparent process for identifying volunteer needs, communicating opportunities, and engaging members in volunteer service.

The Volunteer Ecosystem consists of four primary components:

- **Volunteer Request Form** - Used by Association leaders and National Office staff to identify and request volunteers for organizational needs.
- **Volunteer Inquiry Form** - Allows prospective volunteers to ask questions and learn more about volunteer opportunities before applying.
- **Volunteer Board** - The Association's central resource for promoting available volunteer opportunities.
- **Volunteer Application** - Used by members to apply for specific volunteer positions.

Together, these components provide a coordinated approach to volunteer engagement that supports both the Association's operational needs and members' interests in volunteer service.



Figure 3.3 Volunteer Journey

21.3 Volunteer Opportunities

Volunteer opportunities may exist throughout the Association and may include service with:

- Action Committees
- Task Forces
- Working Groups
- Association Programs
- Board-appointed leadership positions
- Other Board-approved initiatives and special assignments

Volunteer opportunities vary in scope, responsibilities, expected commitment, and qualifications depending on the Association's needs.

21.4 Volunteer Selection and Appointment

Volunteers are selected based on the Association's needs and the qualifications, experience, interests, and perspectives appropriate to the role.

Selection and appointment processes vary by position. Certain leadership positions are appointed by the Board of Directors, while other volunteer positions are selected by the appropriate Association leader in accordance with this Manual and established Association practices.

Submission of a Volunteer Application does not guarantee appointment to a volunteer position.

Applicants who are not immediately selected may be considered for future volunteer opportunities when appropriate.

21.5 Volunteer Selection Process

The Volunteer Engagement process is intended to provide a consistent and transparent approach to matching organizational needs with qualified volunteers.

The normal volunteer selection process includes:

1. An Association leader or National Office staff member identifies a volunteer need through the Volunteer Request Form.

Action Committee Chairs seeking volunteers through an Association-wide recruitment process should submit a Volunteer Request Form so the opportunity may be administered through NAAHP's established Volunteer Engagement process.

2. The opportunity is published through the Volunteer Board.
3. Interested members submit a Volunteer Application and, when appropriate, may first use the Volunteer Inquiry Form to learn more about the opportunity.
4. The National Office reviews applications for completeness and forwards qualified applicants to the appropriate Association leader or appointing authority.
5. The appropriate Association leader evaluates applicants and determines whether to extend a volunteer appointment or recommend another opportunity.
6. The National Office communicates the outcome to the applicant and coordinates onboarding for selected volunteers.
7. The National Office maintains official volunteer rosters.

Throughout the selection process, the National Office serves as the administrative coordinator, while the appropriate Association leader is responsible for evaluating applicants and making selection recommendations or decisions consistent with the authority assigned to the position.

The Association may modify this process as necessary to accommodate the requirements of specific volunteer positions while maintaining consistency with this Manual.

21.6 Onboarding and Volunteer Support

NAAHP is committed to helping volunteers succeed in their assigned roles.

Selected volunteers should receive appropriate orientation, information, resources, and support necessary to understand their responsibilities and contribute effectively to the Association's work.

Association leaders, Program Coordinators, the Executive Director, and National Office staff share responsibility for supporting volunteers in their respective areas.

21.7 Expectations of Volunteers

All volunteers are expected to:

- Support the Association's mission, values, and strategic priorities.
- Perform assigned responsibilities in a professional, respectful, and collaborative manner.

- Maintain appropriate confidentiality when handling Association information.
- Comply with the Association's applicable policies and procedures.
- Communicate openly and responsibly with Association leaders, volunteers, and National Office staff.
- Act in the best interests of the Association.

Additional expectations may be established for specific volunteer roles when appropriate.

21.8 Recognition, Transitions, and Conclusion of Service

NAAHP values the time, expertise, and dedication contributed by its volunteers and is committed to recognizing their service in meaningful ways.

Volunteer service normally concludes upon completion of an appointment, resignation, expiration of a term, completion of an assigned project, or other organizational need.

The Association encourages leadership succession, orderly transitions, and the continued engagement of experienced volunteers in future opportunities whenever appropriate.

The Association may terminate a volunteer appointment when necessary to support its mission, maintain effective operations, or address circumstances inconsistent with the expectations of volunteer service.

PART IV

Association Administration

How NAAHP manages the resources, systems, relationships, and processes that support the Association’s work.

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◆ KEY PRINCIPLE

The Board establishes policy. The Executive Director manages operations. National Office staff administer the Association’s daily work within Board-approved policy.

22. Financial Management

22.1 Purpose

NAAHP manages its financial resources responsibly and transparently in support of the Association's mission, obligations, strategic priorities, and long-term sustainability.

The Board of Directors provides fiduciary oversight and approves the annual budget. The Finance Committee supports the Board through financial review and recommendations. The Executive Director administers the Association's financial operations within the approved budget, Board-approved policies, and delegated authority.

22.2 Fiscal Year and Annual Budget

NAAHP's fiscal year begins January 1 and ends December 31.

The Executive Director prepares the proposed annual budget with support from National Office staff and in collaboration with the Treasurer and Finance Committee. The budget should reflect anticipated revenue and expenses, organizational priorities, staffing and operational needs, contractual obligations, planned initiatives, reserves, cash-flow needs, and significant financial risks.

The Finance Committee reviews the proposed budget and recommends a budget to the Board. The Board approves the annual budget. Following approval, the Executive Director administers the budget and reports significant variances or emerging financial concerns to the Finance Committee and Board.

22.3 Expenditures and Financial Commitments

The Executive Director and authorized National Office staff may approve and process expenditures included in the approved budget within their delegated authority.

All expenditures must:

- serve a legitimate Association purpose;
- comply with the approved budget and applicable requirements;
- receive the required authorization;
- be supported by appropriate documentation; and
 - be recorded accurately.

Expenditures not included in the approved budget require the following approval:

Table 2 Approval Requirements for Unbudgeted Expenditures

Unbudgeted expenditure	Required approval
Up to \$500	Executive Director
\$501 through \$1,000	Executive Director and Treasurer
\$1,001 through \$2,000	Finance Committee
\$2,001 through \$10,000	Finance Committee and Executive Committee
More than \$10,000	Board of Directors, following recommendations from the Finance Committee and Executive Committee

Related expenditures may not be divided or processed separately to avoid an approval requirement. Financial approval does not authorize a person to execute a contract or otherwise bind the Association. Contract and signing authority are addressed in Section 26, Contracts and Agreements. (p. 86)

22.4 Banking and Financial Accounts

Association funds shall be maintained in authorized accounts with appropriate safeguards.

Account access and signature authority shall be assigned through Board-approved or delegated authority and updated when leadership, staffing, banking relationships, or operational needs change.

No individual may authorize a payment to themselves or approve a change to their own compensation. Matters involving the Executive Director's compensation shall be approved by the Board or an Officer authorized by the Board.

The Executive Director is responsible for the administration of banking, payroll, cash flow, transfers, and other routine financial activities and may delegate administrative responsibilities to qualified National Office staff or external service providers.

22.5 Investments and Reserves

NAAHP shall manage its investments and reserves prudently to support financial stability, liquidity, and long-term sustainability.

The Finance Committee exercises investment authority delegated by the Board. The Executive Director administers authorized investment transactions and maintains the related records.

Investment decisions should consider preservation of principal, liquidity, anticipated obligations, risk, duration, expected return, and diversification, as appropriate. Investments and reserves shall be reviewed periodically and managed in accordance with any applicable Board-approved investment or reserve policies.

22.6 Internal Controls and Financial Records

NAAHP shall maintain financial controls appropriate to its size, staffing, activities, and financial risks.

Controls should provide reasonable assurance that:

- transactions are properly authorized;
- financial records are accurate and complete;
- assets and financial systems are protected;
- accounts are reconciled regularly;
- payments and reimbursements are documented;
- financial responsibilities are appropriately separated when practical; and
 - suspected errors, misuse, or irregularities are reported and addressed.

The Executive Director is responsible for maintaining appropriate financial systems, controls, and records. Detailed financial procedures may be established and revised administratively without amendment to this Manual.

Official financial records shall be maintained in accordance with Section 27, Association Records and Information Management. (p. 89)

22.7 Financial Reporting

The National Office shall prepare timely and understandable financial reports sufficient to support oversight by the Treasurer, Finance Committee, and Board.

Financial reporting should address, as applicable:

- the Association's financial position;
- revenue and expenditures;
- performance against the approved budget;
- cash and liquidity;
- investments and reserves;
- significant obligations;
- material variances; and
 - emerging financial risks.

The Treasurer and Finance Committee review the Association's financial reports and bring significant concerns or recommendations to the Board.

22.8 Independent Audit and Regulatory Reporting

NAAHP shall obtain an annual independent audit and complete required tax filings and other financial reports in accordance with applicable law and Board direction.

The Finance Committee oversees the audit process on behalf of the Board, reviews the auditor's findings and recommendations, and monitors appropriate follow-up.

The Executive Director and National Office staff coordinate the audit, maintain supporting records, respond to information requests, and ensure that required filings are completed accurately and on time. The annual audit requirement is an existing Board-approved financial accountability measure.

22.9 Travel and Reimbursement

NAAHP may reimburse reasonable and necessary expenses incurred for authorized Association business.

Travel and other reimbursable expenses must:

- support an approved Association purpose;
- be authorized in advance;
- remain within the approved budget or receive the required additional approval;
- comply with applicable reimbursement requirements; and
- be supported by appropriate documentation.

The Executive Director administers travel and reimbursement practices and may establish procedures addressing eligible expenses, documentation, reimbursement limits, submission timelines, and exceptions.

22.10 Responsibilities

Board of Directors

The Board approves the annual budget, establishes financial policy, and retains ultimate responsibility for the Association's financial stewardship.

Finance Committee

The Finance Committee reviews the Association's financial condition, proposed budget, investments, reserves, internal controls, audit results, significant financial risks, and other matters within its assigned responsibilities. It makes recommendations to the Board and exercises only the authority delegated to it.

Treasurer

The Treasurer provides leadership for the Board's financial oversight responsibilities, reviews financial information, supports the Finance Committee, and helps ensure that significant financial matters are brought to the appropriate governing body.

Executive Director

The Executive Director administers the Association's finances, approved budget, financial systems, internal controls, banking relationships, reporting, audit coordination, and routine financial operations. The Executive Director may delegate administrative duties while retaining overall accountability.

National Office Staff

Authorized National Office staff carry out assigned accounting, payment, reporting, recordkeeping, and other financial responsibilities under the direction of the Executive Director.

23. Membership

23.1 Purpose

Membership is central to NAAHP's mission of advancing health professions advising through professional development, collaboration, and service to the advising community.

This section describes the Association's membership framework and the responsibilities for administering membership. Membership categories, eligibility requirements, voting rights, and other governing provisions are established by the NAAHP Bylaws.

23.2 Membership Framework

NAAHP offers membership categories for individuals and organizations that support the Association's mission.

Membership categories, eligibility requirements, voting rights, leadership eligibility, suspension, termination, and resignation are governed by Article III of the Bylaws.

The Board of Directors may establish additional membership classifications as authorized by the Bylaws.

23.3 Membership Administration

The Executive Director is responsible for administering the Association's membership program in accordance with the Bylaws and Board-approved policies.

Membership administration includes:

- processing applications and renewals;
- determining or confirming membership classifications;
- maintaining official membership records;
- collecting approved membership dues;
- communicating membership information and benefits; and
- supporting member engagement and retention.

When questions regarding membership eligibility or classification cannot be resolved through routine administration, the Executive Director may consult the appropriate Association leadership or refer the matter to the Board when a policy determination is required.

23.4 Membership Dues

National membership dues and fees are established by the Board of Directors.

The Board has adopted a tiered dues structure for Association membership. Current tier definitions and dues amounts are maintained separately as Board-approved membership rates and may be revised by the Board without amendment to this Manual.

The Finance Committee may review and make recommendations regarding membership dues as part of the Association's financial planning process.

Regional Association dues, when applicable, are established by the respective Regional Associations.

Administrative procedures governing billing, payment methods, renewal notices, refunds, and related membership administration may be established by the Executive Director.

23.5 Membership Term and Renewal

Membership is maintained through the application or renewal process established by the Association.

Members are responsible for maintaining accurate membership information, meeting applicable eligibility requirements, and paying approved dues to remain in good standing.

Administrative procedures governing membership applications, renewals, reinstatement, and related processes may be established by the Executive Director.

23.6 Membership Records

The National Office maintains the Association's official membership records.

Membership information shall be maintained in accordance with applicable privacy requirements and Section 27, Association Records and Information Management. (p. 89)

23.7 Responsibilities

Board of Directors

The Board establishes membership policy, approves membership dues, and oversees the Association's membership framework.

Executive Director

The Executive Director administers the membership program, implements Board-approved membership policies, maintains official membership records, and oversees day-to-day membership operations.

National Office Staff

National Office staff support membership administration by processing applications and renewals, maintaining membership records, communicating with members, and providing administrative support.

24. National Conference and Events

24.1 Purpose

Conferences and events advance NAAHP's mission by providing professional development, leadership engagement, governance activities, networking opportunities, and collaboration within the health professions advising community.

This section describes the Association's framework for planning, approving, and administering conferences and events. Detailed planning procedures, operational guidance, and event-specific policies are maintained in separate companion documents.

24.2 Association Events

NAAHP conducts a variety of conferences, meetings, educational programs, and other events in support of its mission. These may include:

- the National Conference;
- Board and committee meetings;
- leadership meetings and retreats;
- educational programs and webinars;
- meetings of Action Committees, Working Groups, Task Forces, and Association Programs; and
- other Association-sponsored events approved through established authority.

The format, schedule, and location of Association events are determined according to organizational needs, available resources, and delegated authority.

24.3 National Conference

The National Conference is NAAHP's premier educational and professional development event and is ordinarily conducted during even-numbered years.

The Conference provides opportunities for:

- professional education;
- networking and collaboration;
- leadership development;
- recognition of member achievement;
- engagement with partner organizations; and
- conducting official Association business, as appropriate.

The Board establishes the strategic direction and major policies governing the National Conference. The Executive Director is responsible for administering the Conference in accordance with Board-approved policies, the approved budget, and delegated authority. Conference Planning Chair(s), committees, volunteers, and National Office staff support the Conference within their assigned responsibilities.

24.4 Conference Governance

Responsibility for Association conferences and events is shared between the Board of Directors and the Executive Director.

The Board establishes policy, approves significant financial commitments reserved to it, and provides strategic oversight.

The Executive Director manages conference operations, implements the Conference Planning Committee (CPC) direction, coordinates planning and logistics with the Conference Planning Chair(s), and may establish administrative procedures necessary for the successful delivery of Association events.

Conference planning leadership may be structured with one Chair, Co-Chairs, or another Board-approved arrangement. Figure 4.1 illustrates a co-chair configuration but does not establish a required number of Conference Planning Chairs.



Figure 4.1 Conference Governance Structure

24.5 Educational Programs and Other Events

In addition to the National Conference, NAAHP sponsors educational, leadership, governance, and member engagement activities throughout the year.

These programs may be delivered in person, virtually, or through hybrid formats and may be conducted independently or in collaboration with partner organizations.

The Executive Director may approve and administer routine Association events within delegated authority.

24.6 Responsibilities

Board of Directors

The Board establishes policies governing Association conferences and events, approves matters reserved to the Board, and provides strategic and financial oversight.

Executive Director

The Executive Director administers Association conferences and events, oversees planning and implementation, manages budgets and contracts within delegated authority, and coordinates the work of National Office staff, Conference Planning Chair(s), volunteers, and service providers.

Conference Planning Leadership

Conference Planning Chair(s) and planning committees provide volunteer leadership for the development of the National Conference and other assigned events. The Board may appoint one or more Conference Planning Chairs based on the needs of the conference. Conference Planning leadership works collaboratively with the Executive Director and National Office staff and performs responsibilities assigned through their appointments and conference planning guidance.

National Office Staff

National Office staff provide administrative, operational, financial, communications, registration, and logistical support for Association conferences and events.

25. Publications and Communications

25.1 Purpose

NAAHP publications and communications support the Association's mission by providing accurate, timely, and professional information to members, volunteers, partners, stakeholders, and the public.

This section explains how official publications, communications, public statements, branding, and related materials are administered. Detailed editorial, production, distribution, and communications practices are maintained separately.

25.2 Publications and Communications

NAAHP produces publications, educational resources, reports, newsletters, websites, digital content, conference materials, and other communications that support its mission, programs, services, and organizational responsibilities.

The Executive Director is responsible for administering the Association's publications and communications activities and may assign responsibilities to National Office staff, editors, contractors, committees, volunteers, or other authorized individuals.

Publication schedules, editorial processes, production methods, distribution practices, and communication channels are managed through administrative procedures or publication-specific guidance.

25.3 Official Public Statements

Official public statements made on behalf of NAAHP must accurately reflect the Association's approved policies and positions.

The President and Executive Director may issue official public statements on behalf of the Association within their respective authority. Another individual may serve as an official spokesperson when authorized by the Board, Executive Committee, President, or Executive Director, as appropriate.

Board members, Officers, volunteers, committee members, and other individuals affiliated with NAAHP may express personal views but may not present those views as official positions of the Association unless authorized to do so.

25.4 Branding and Association Identity

NAAHP's name, logo, trademarks, letterhead, visual identity, and other branding elements are Association assets.

The Executive Director administers the use of NAAHP branding and may authorize its use for official Association purposes. Detailed standards governing logos, templates, letterhead, and other visual materials are maintained separately.

Use of NAAHP branding does not, by itself, authorize an individual or group to speak for, obligate, or formally represent the Association.

25.5 Advertising, Sponsorship, and Endorsement

NAAHP may include advertising, sponsorship recognition, exhibitor information, or other promotional content in its publications, communications, events, websites, and digital platforms.

Acceptance or publication of such content does not constitute NAAHP endorsement of an organization, product, service, position, or viewpoint unless the Association expressly approves an endorsement through authorized action.

Advertising and sponsorship arrangements are administered in accordance with applicable Association policies, agreements, and financial requirements.

25.6 Intellectual Property and Published Content

Publications, educational materials, graphics, digital content, and other works developed by or for NAAHP are administered in accordance with applicable agreements and Association requirements.

Ownership, copyright, permission, licensing, attribution, and reuse should be addressed through appropriate publication, contributor, presenter, contractor, or other written agreements.

Publication of an article, presentation, advertisement, opinion, or other contributed content does not necessarily indicate that the content represents the official position of NAAHP.

25.7 Responsibilities

Board of Directors

The Board establishes or approves significant policies and official positions affecting Association publications and communications.

President

The President may communicate official Board positions and represent the Association within the authority of the office.

Executive Director

The Executive Director administers the Association's publications, communications, branding, public relations, and related activities within Board-approved policy, the approved budget, and delegated authority.

National Office Staff and Authorized Contributors

National Office staff, editors, contractors, committees, volunteers, and other authorized contributors carry out assigned publication and communication responsibilities under the appropriate organizational oversight.

26. Contracts and Agreements

26.1 Purpose

NAAHP enters into contracts, agreements, and purchasing arrangements to support its mission, programs, services, and operations.

This section establishes the authority to approve, execute, and administer contracts and procurement activities while ensuring appropriate financial stewardship, legal compliance, and organizational accountability.

26.2 Contracting Authority

The Board of Directors establishes policies governing contracts and significant financial commitments.

The Executive Director is responsible for negotiating, administering, and overseeing contracts and agreements within Board-approved policies, the approved budget, and delegated authority.

Only individuals specifically authorized by Board policy or delegated authority may execute contracts or otherwise obligate the Association.

Approval of funding or a project does not, by itself, authorize execution of a contract or agreement.

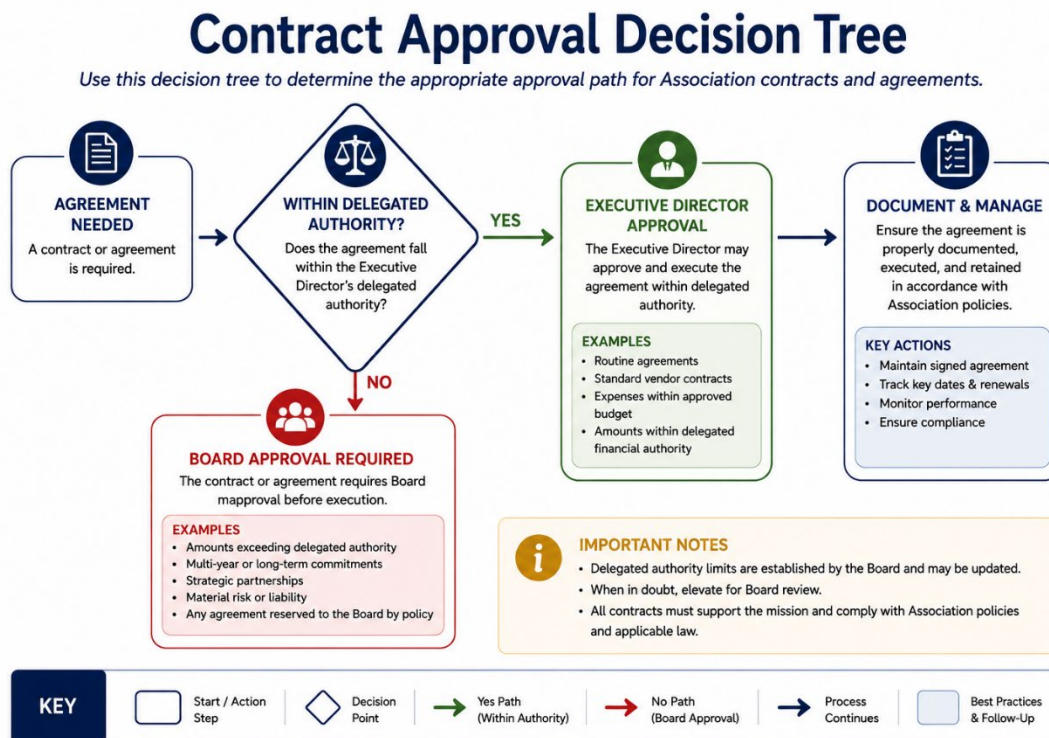


Figure 4.2 Contract Approval Decision Tree

26.3 Types of Agreements

NAAHP may enter into contracts and agreements that support its mission and operations, including:

- service and consulting agreements;
- venue and event contracts;
- sponsorship and exhibitor agreements;
- partnership and collaboration agreements;
- grant agreements;
- software, technology, and licensing agreements;
- purchasing and procurement contracts; and
- other agreements approved through appropriate authority.

The Executive Director may establish administrative procedures appropriate to the type and complexity of an agreement.

26.4 Procurement

Goods and services should be obtained through fair, ethical, and fiscally responsible procurement practices that serve the best interests of the Association.

Procurement decisions should consider factors such as:

- organizational needs;
- quality and capability;
- cost and overall value;
- financial and operational risk;
- contractual obligations; and
- long-term sustainability.

The Executive Director may establish administrative procurement procedures, including competitive purchasing practices, documentation requirements, and approval workflows appropriate to the nature and value of the purchase.

26.5 Contract Administration

The Executive Director is responsible for administering contracts throughout their term.

Contract administration includes, as appropriate:

- coordinating contract review and negotiation;
- monitoring performance and deliverables;
- maintaining official contract records;
- overseeing renewals, amendments, and terminations;
- monitoring financial obligations; and
- addressing contract compliance issues.

Routine administration may be delegated to National Office staff while overall accountability remains with the Executive Director.

26.6 Legal Review

Legal counsel should be consulted whenever necessary to protect the interests of the Association, comply with applicable law, or address significant legal or contractual issues.

The Executive Director determines when legal review is appropriate unless the Board directs otherwise.

26.7 Responsibilities

Board of Directors

The Board establishes contract and procurement policy, approves matters reserved to the Board, and delegates contracting authority as appropriate.

Executive Director

The Executive Director negotiates, administers, and oversees contracts and procurement activities within delegated authority, ensures compliance with Association policy, and maintains appropriate contract records.

National Office Staff

Authorized National Office staff support procurement, contract administration, recordkeeping, payment processing, and vendor coordination under the direction of the Executive Director.

27. Association Records and Information Management

27.1 Purpose

NAAHP maintains official records to document the Association's governance, operations, financial activities, legal obligations, and institutional history.

This section establishes the policies governing the ownership, management, retention, accessibility, and preservation of official Association records.

27.2 Association Records

Records created or received in the conduct of Association business are the property of NAAHP, regardless of format or the individual who created or maintains them.

Official records may include governance documents, financial records, contracts, membership records, conference records, publications, committee records, correspondence, electronic records, and other information maintained in support of Association business.

Personal working files, duplicate copies, and transitory communications are not official Association records unless designated otherwise.

27.3 Record Management

The Executive Director is responsible for administering the Association's records management program.

Official records shall be maintained in Association-approved repositories designated by the Executive Director. Individuals conducting Association business are responsible for ensuring that official records within their responsibility are maintained in those approved repositories.

The Executive Director may establish administrative procedures governing records organization, retention, access, disposition, and related records management practices.

27.4 Record Retention and Disposition

Official records shall be retained for periods appropriate to their administrative, legal, financial, historical, and operational value and in accordance with applicable law and Board-approved policies.

Records that are no longer required may be disposed of in accordance with the Association's records retention procedures.

When litigation, investigation, audit, or other legal action is pending or reasonably anticipated, relevant records shall be preserved until the matter has been resolved.

Association Records Lifecycle

Official Association records are created, managed, and protected throughout their lifecycle to ensure accountability, continuity, and compliance.

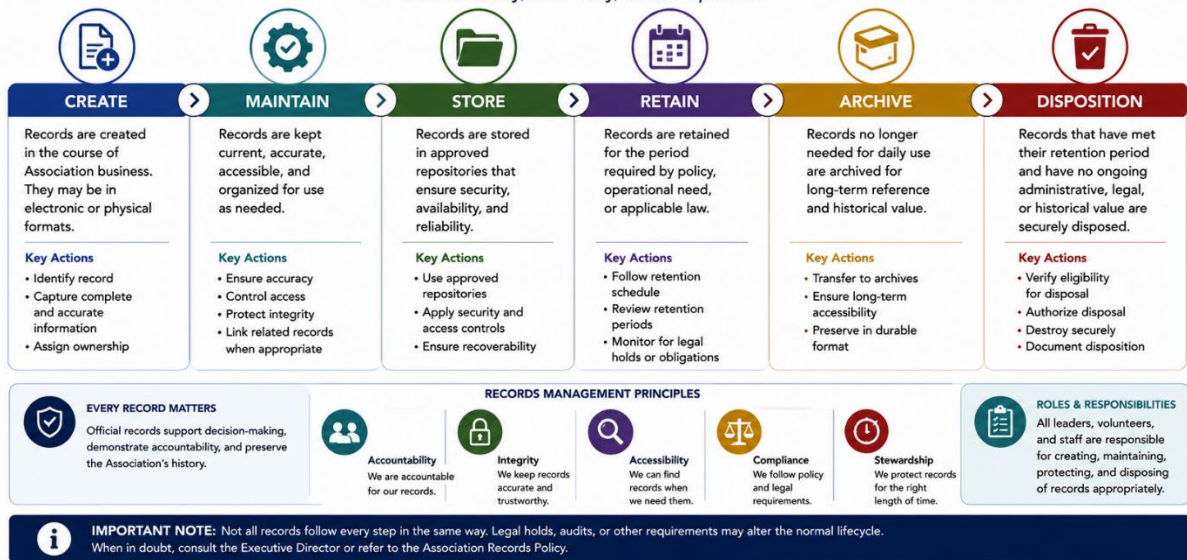


Figure 4.3 Association Records Lifecycle

Official Records vs. Working Documents

Understanding the difference helps us protect what matters and work more efficiently.

	OFFICIAL RECORD	WORKING DOCUMENT
	Final, approved, or executed documents that have enduring legal, fiscal, or historical value to the Association.	Temporary or in-progress materials used to create, review, or support work. They do not have enduring value.
Board Minutes	- Approved minutes of Board, Executive Committee, and Finance Committee meetings. - The official record of decisions and actions taken.	- Personal notes taken during meetings. - Handwritten notes or individual summaries.
Approved Policies	- Final, Board-approved policies. - The authoritative version in effect.	- Draft policies under development. - Markup versions or tracked changes.
Executed Contracts & Agreements	- Fully executed contracts and agreements. - All amendments and renewals.	- Draft or review copies. - Negotiation notes or redlines.
Official Correspondence	- Final correspondence on official Association business. - Signed letters, official emails, and formal notices.	- Convenience copies or extra email copies. - Personal email drafts or informal messages.
Final Reports	- Final reports approved or accepted. - Reports that document decisions or results.	- Draft reports, outlines, or brainstorming documents. - Analysis files or working spreadsheets.
Financial Records	- Official financial statements, budgets, audits, ledgers, and tax filings. - Supporting documentation per retention policy.	- Working spreadsheets and calculations. - Preliminary budgets or scenario planning files.
WHY IT MATTERS	Properly identifying and managing official records: - Ensures compliance with legal and retention requirements - Protects the Association's history and decision-making - Improves efficiency and reduces risk	GOOD PRACTICE When in doubt, treat the document as an official record or consult the Executive Director or refer to the Association Records Policy.
MANAGE OFFICIAL RECORDS SECURELY	Official records must be stored in Association-approved repositories with appropriate access controls and retention safeguards.	
	Official records document our decisions, obligations, and achievements. Working documents help us get the work done. <i>Let's protect what matters and work smart every step of the way.</i>	

Figure 4.4 Official Records vs. Working Documents

27.5 Access and Confidentiality

Access to official Association records shall be consistent with applicable law, Board-approved policies, organizational responsibilities, and the need to protect confidential information.

Individuals granted access to Association records are responsible for safeguarding confidential, proprietary, and sensitive information and using such information only for authorized Association purposes.

27.6 Leadership Transitions

Upon completion of a leadership, volunteer, staff, or contractual assignment, official Association records shall be transferred promptly to the appropriate Association-approved repository or successor, as directed by the Executive Director.

No individual retains ownership of official Association records after leaving an Association role.

27.7 Responsibilities

Board of Directors

The Board establishes records management policy and provides oversight of the Association's stewardship of official records.

Executive Director

The Executive Director administers the Association's records management program, designates approved record repositories, establishes administrative procedures, and ensures appropriate preservation of official records.

National Office Staff

National Office staff maintain official records within their assigned responsibilities and administer records management practices established by the Executive Director.

Association Leaders, Volunteers, and Contractors

Individuals conducting Association business are responsible for creating, maintaining, protecting, and transferring official Association records in accordance with this Manual and applicable administrative procedures.

28. Technology and Systems

28.1 Purpose

Technology and information resources support NAAHP's governance, operations, member services, communications, educational programs, conferences, financial management, and records.

This section establishes the policies governing the administration, protection, and appropriate use of the Association's technology resources and information assets.

28.2 Technology Administration

The Executive Director is responsible for administering the Association's technology resources in accordance with Board-approved policies, the approved budget, and delegated authority.

The Executive Director may assign operational responsibilities to National Office staff, including the Program Specialist, Technology, and may engage external technology providers, consultants, or contractors as appropriate.

Technology administration includes, as appropriate:

- business systems and software;
- websites and digital platforms;
- technology infrastructure and services;
- information security;
- technology planning;
- technology vendors; and
- technology support.

28.3 Technology Planning

Technology decisions should support the Association's mission, strategic priorities, operational effectiveness, financial stewardship, security, and long-term sustainability.

The Executive Director may approve routine technology acquisitions, subscriptions, services, and system improvements within delegated authority.

Technology initiatives requiring Board approval shall be presented through the Association's established governance process.

28.4 Information Management

Information created, received, maintained, or transmitted in support of Association business shall be managed responsibly and protected according to its operational, legal, financial, and organizational importance.

Official records shall be maintained in accordance with Section 27, Association Records and Information Management. (p. 89)

28.5 Acceptable Use

Technology resources are provided primarily for authorized Association business.

Individuals using Association technology resources are expected to:

- protect Association information;
- comply with applicable law and Association policies;
- use technology responsibly and ethically;
- safeguard passwords and authentication credentials;
- promptly report suspected security concerns; and
- avoid unauthorized access, software, or use of Association resources.

The Executive Director may establish administrative standards governing acceptable use and technology security.

28.6 Information Security

NAAHP shall maintain reasonable administrative, technical, and operational safeguards appropriate to the size and complexity of the Association.

Safeguards should protect:

- confidential information;
- member information;
- financial information;
- official Association records;
- technology systems; and
- digital services.

Security practices may include user access controls, authentication, backups, software updates, monitoring, incident response, disaster recovery, vendor management, and other appropriate administrative safeguards.

28.7 Artificial Intelligence and Emerging Technology

NAAHP recognizes that artificial intelligence and other emerging technologies may improve organizational effectiveness while also introducing legal, ethical, operational, and information-security considerations.

The Executive Director may authorize the use of emerging technologies when appropriate safeguards are in place, and the technology supports the Association's mission and operational needs.

Technology use shall remain consistent with applicable law, Board-approved policy, confidentiality requirements, contractual obligations, and responsible stewardship of Association information.

28.8 Responsibilities

Board of Directors

The Board establishes technology policy, approves significant technology initiatives reserved to the Board, and provides oversight of technology risks affecting the Association.

Executive Director

The Executive Director administers the Association's technology resources, information systems, cybersecurity practices, technology planning, vendor relationships, and operational technology decisions.

Program Specialist, Technology

The Program Specialist, Technology, supports the administration, maintenance, implementation, security, and improvement of the Association's technology resources under the direction of the Executive Director.

National Office Staff

National Office staff use Association technology responsibly, protect Association information, comply with applicable policies and procedures, and promptly report technology or security concerns.

Volunteers and Authorized Users

Individuals granted access to Association technology resources shall use those resources only for authorized Association purposes and shall protect Association information entrusted to them.

29. Risk Management

29.1 Purpose

NAAHP identifies and manages risks that could materially affect its mission, people, finances, operations, legal obligations, reputation, programs, technology, information, or long-term sustainability.

Risk management supports informed decision-making and responsible stewardship. It does not require the elimination of all risk. The Association may accept reasonable risk when it has been appropriately considered and is consistent with authorized organizational objectives.

29.2 Risk Management Policy

NAAHP shall maintain a practical and proportionate approach to risk management.

Significant risks should be identified and considered when making major decisions involving finances, contracts, technology, information, conferences, programs, partnerships, personnel, volunteers, and member services.

Responsibility for managing a risk shall be assigned to the individual or organizational body with the appropriate authority. Safeguards, documentation, and oversight should be proportionate to the likelihood and potential effect of the risk.

29.3 Risk Oversight and Administration

The Board of Directors provides oversight of material strategic, fiduciary, legal, and organizational risks.

The Executive Director administers the Association's risk-management practices and manages operational risks within delegated authority. This includes identifying significant risks, implementing appropriate safeguards, coordinating incident response, obtaining professional advice, and keeping the appropriate governing bodies informed.

The Finance Committee reviews significant financial risks within its responsibilities. The Executive Committee reviews significant governance, legal, personnel, strategic, and reputational risks referred to it within its delegated authority.

29.4 Legal and Regulatory Compliance

NAAHP shall conduct its affairs in accordance with applicable law, its Articles of Incorporation, Bylaws, Board-approved policies, contractual obligations, and other binding requirements.

The Executive Director administers the Association's compliance activities and may obtain legal, accounting, insurance, technology, or other professional advice when necessary and within delegated authority.

Requests for legal advice concerning official Association business shall be coordinated through the Executive Director unless the matter involves the Executive Director. In that circumstance, the request shall be coordinated through the President or another Officer authorized by the Board.

29.5 Insurance

NAAHP shall maintain insurance coverage appropriate to its activities, obligations, assets, personnel, volunteers, programs, and reasonably anticipated risks.

The Executive Director administers the Association's insurance program, including coverage review, renewals, certificates, reporting requirements, and claims coordination.

The Finance Committee reviews significant insurance matters affecting the Association's financial condition or risk exposure and makes recommendations when appropriate.

Insurance does not replace sound judgment, internal controls, contractual protections, or other appropriate risk-management practices.

29.6 Incident Reporting and Response

Directors, Officers, National Office staff, volunteers, contractors, and others conducting Association business shall promptly report significant incidents, suspected violations, threats, losses, or other material concerns through the appropriate organizational channel.

The Executive Director coordinates the Association's operational response to incidents within delegated authority and may take immediate action when delay could increase harm or interfere with an effective response.

Incident response may include:

- protecting individuals, information, systems, funds, and other Association assets;
- limiting further harm;
- preserving relevant records and evidence;
- obtaining legal, insurance, technology, or other professional assistance;
- making required notifications;
- coordinating investigation and corrective action;
- restoring affected operations; and
- recommending changes to policies, procedures, controls, contracts, or safeguards.

When an incident involves the Executive Director, it shall be reported to the President or another Officer authorized by the Board.

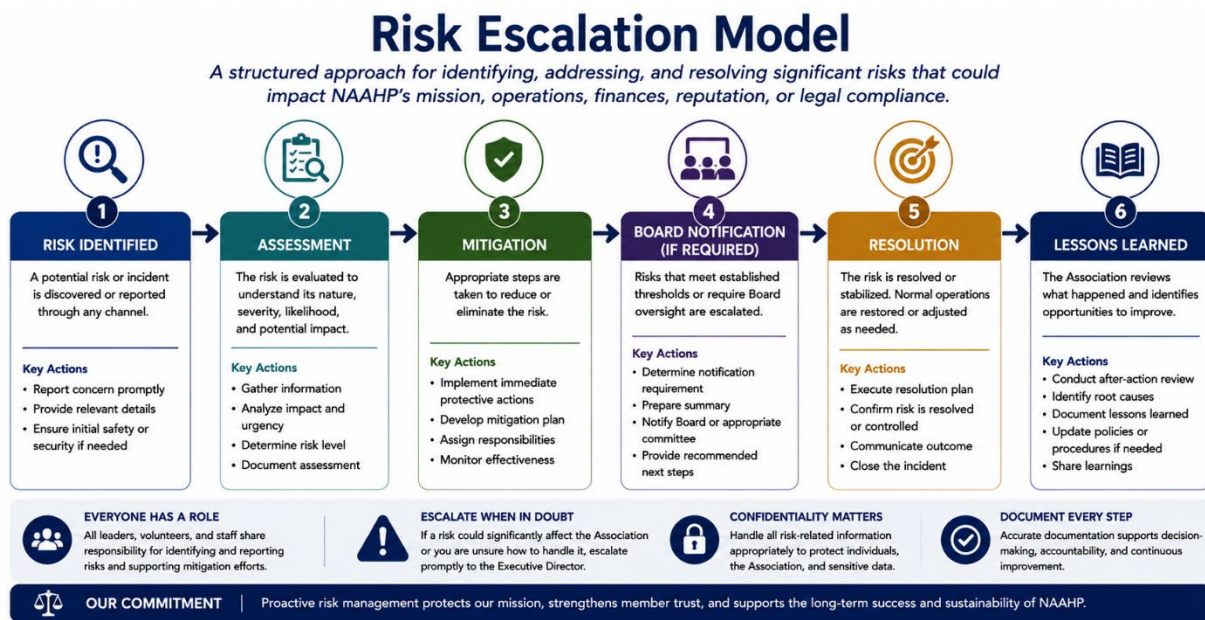


Figure 4.5 Risk Escalation Model

29.7 Board Notification and Escalation

The Executive Director shall promptly notify the President and the appropriate governing body when a risk or incident:

- may materially affect the Association’s mission, finances, operations, reputation, or legal position;
- exceeds delegated financial or contractual authority;
- involves a Director, Officer, or the Executive Director;
- may significantly interrupt Association operations;
- could affect the safety or rights of individuals;
- may require an official public statement;
- requires adoption or amendment of Board policy; or
- otherwise warrants governance oversight.

Financial matters should ordinarily be referred to the Finance Committee. Significant governance, legal, strategic, personnel, or reputational matters should ordinarily be referred to the Executive Committee or Board, as appropriate.

29.8 Confidentiality and Records

Risk assessments, legal communications, incident reports, investigations, insurance claims, and related materials shall be protected according to their sensitivity and applicable requirements.

Access shall be limited to individuals with a legitimate governance, legal, administrative, insurance, or operational need.

Official records shall be maintained in accordance with Section 27, Association Records and Information Management. Records relevant to litigation, investigations, audits, claims, or anticipated disputes shall be preserved while a legal hold or other preservation requirement remains in effect. (p. 89)

29.9 Review and Corrective Action

Following a significant incident or near miss, the Executive Director shall determine whether changes are needed to policies, procedures, internal controls, contracts, insurance coverage, technology, training, staffing, assigned responsibilities, or continuity planning.

Recommendations requiring governing action shall be presented through the appropriate decision-making pathway.

29.10 Responsibilities

Board of Directors

The Board establishes risk-management policy, oversees material organizational risks, and considers risk when making significant policy, strategic, and fiduciary decisions.

Finance Committee

The Finance Committee reviews significant financial risks and makes recommendations concerning financial controls, reserves, investments, insurance, contracts, and related matters within its responsibilities.

Executive Committee

The Executive Committee reviews significant governance, legal, personnel, strategic, and reputational risks referred to it within its delegated authority.

Executive Director

The Executive Director administers the Association's risk-management framework, manages operational risks, coordinates incident response, implements safeguards, obtains professional advice, and keeps the appropriate governing bodies informed.

National Office Staff

National Office staff manage risks within their assigned responsibilities, follow established safeguards and procedures, protect Association assets and information, and report significant concerns promptly.

Association Leaders and Volunteers

Officers, committee participants, program leaders, coordinators, and volunteers shall consider risk within their assigned responsibilities and promptly report significant concerns. They may not independently retain professional services, commit Association resources, make official public statements, or direct an organizational response unless authorized.

30. External Relationships

30.1 Purpose

NAAHP maintains relationships with organizations that share an interest in advancing health professions advising and supporting the Association's mission.

These relationships strengthen collaboration, improve communication, expand professional development opportunities, and promote the exchange of information across the health professions advising community.

This section provides an overview of NAAHP's external organizational relationships and identifies the roles responsible for maintaining them.

30.2 Organizational Relationships

NAAHP collaborates with a variety of organizations, including:

- Health professions associations
- Regional Associations
- Colleges and universities
- Nonprofit and professional organizations
- Government agencies
- Corporate sponsors and partners
- Other organizations whose activities support the Association's mission

Relationships may range from informal collaboration to formal partnerships established through written agreements.

Formal agreements are administered in accordance with Section 26, Contracts and Agreements. (p. 86)

30.3 Advisory Council

The Advisory Council provides a forum for communication and collaboration between NAAHP and participating health professions associations.

The Council serves in an advisory capacity by sharing information, discussing issues affecting health professions advising, and strengthening relationships between participating organizations and NAAHP.

The Advisory Council operates in accordance with the NAAHP Bylaws.

Board Review Note

The Advisory Council is currently governed by the NAAHP Bylaws. Because the Board is evaluating potential amendments affecting the Council's future role and structure, this section should be reviewed following the adoption of any related Bylaw changes.

30.4 Liaisons

From time to time, members of NAAHP Executive Leadership may be designated to serve as official Liaisons to external organizations or associations.

Liaisons represent the Association within the scope of their assigned responsibilities, promote communication between organizations, and help strengthen strategic relationships.

Liaisons serve only within the authority delegated by the Board of Directors or assigned through their leadership position.

30.5 Ambassador Program

The NAAHP Ambassador Program provides a structured approach for maintaining relationships with health professions associations that are active Association Members of NAAHP.

Ambassadors serve as NAAHP representatives to their assigned organizations by promoting communication, sharing information, identifying opportunities for collaboration, and supporting relationships between the organizations.

The Ambassador Coordinator administers the Ambassador Program in accordance with Board-approved policy and applicable program procedures.

Additional information regarding the Ambassador Program is provided in Section 20, Association Programs, Section 21, Volunteer Engagement, and the Association's Ambassador Program guidelines. (pp. 68 and 70)

30.6 Responsibilities

Board of Directors

The Board establishes policy governing NAAHP's external relationships and provides oversight of strategic partnerships and organizational collaborations.

Executive Director

The Executive Director administers the Association's external relationships, supports the implementation of Board-approved partnerships and agreements, and provides operational oversight consistent with delegated authority.

Ambassador Coordinator

The Ambassador Coordinator administers the NAAHP Ambassador Program, coordinates Ambassador assignments and communications, provides guidance and support to Ambassadors, and serves as the primary point of coordination for the program.

Executive Leadership Liaisons

Executive Leadership members serving as Liaisons represent NAAHP in relationships with designated external organizations or associations within the scope of their assigned responsibilities and delegated authority.

Ambassadors

Ambassadors represent NAAHP through the Ambassador Program by fostering communication and collaboration with their assigned health professions associations, sharing information of mutual interest, and supporting productive relationships between the organizations.

31. Awards and Recognition

31.1 Purpose

NAAHP recognizes individuals and organizations whose service, leadership, scholarship, innovation, and contributions advance the Association and the health professions advising community.

This section establishes the framework for the Association's awards and recognition programs while allowing individual awards and recognition initiatives to be administered through separate Board-approved policies, guidelines, and administrative procedures.

31.2 National Awards

NAAHP maintains a program of National Awards to recognize outstanding achievement, leadership, innovation, scholarship, volunteer service, and other contributions that support the Association's mission and the profession of health professions advising.

National Awards are established by the Board of Directors and are ordinarily presented during the Biennial National Conference.

The Board may establish, modify, suspend, or discontinue National Awards as organizational needs evolve.

The eligibility criteria, nomination process, selection procedures, and evaluation standards for individual awards shall be maintained in Board-approved award policies or companion guidelines.

31.3 Carol Baffi-Dugan Award for Service

NAAHP sponsors the Carol Baffi-Dugan Award for Service to recognize exceptional volunteer service to both a Regional Association and NAAHP.

One recipient may be selected from each Regional Association for recognition during the Biennial National Conference.

Each Regional Association is responsible for selecting and submitting its recipient in accordance with the established award criteria and nomination process. NAAHP administers the overall program and coordinates recognition of the recipients.

The Board may amend the program, eligibility requirements, or selection framework through Board-approved policy.

31.4 Recognition Program

In addition to its formal awards, NAAHP maintains a year-round Recognition Program that acknowledges the achievements, service, and contributions of members, volunteers, leaders, partners, and others who advance the Association's mission.

Recognition may include volunteer service, leadership milestones, program accomplishments, member achievements, retirements, memorial recognitions, institutional partnerships, anniversaries, and other contributions determined appropriate by the Association.

The Executive Director may administer routine recognition activities and establish administrative procedures for the Recognition Program. Significant recognition initiatives or honorary designations established on behalf of the Association shall be approved by the Board of Directors or its delegated authority.

31.5 Administration

The Executive Director administers the Association's Awards and Recognition Program in accordance with Board-approved policies and delegated authority.

Administrative responsibilities may include:

- Coordinating nominations and applications.
- Supporting selection committees.
- Maintaining award and recognition records.
- Coordinating recipient notifications.
- Planning award presentations and recognition activities.
- Maintaining historical records of recipients.
- Supporting communications related to awards and recognition.

The Executive Director may assign these responsibilities to National Office staff or other authorized individuals.

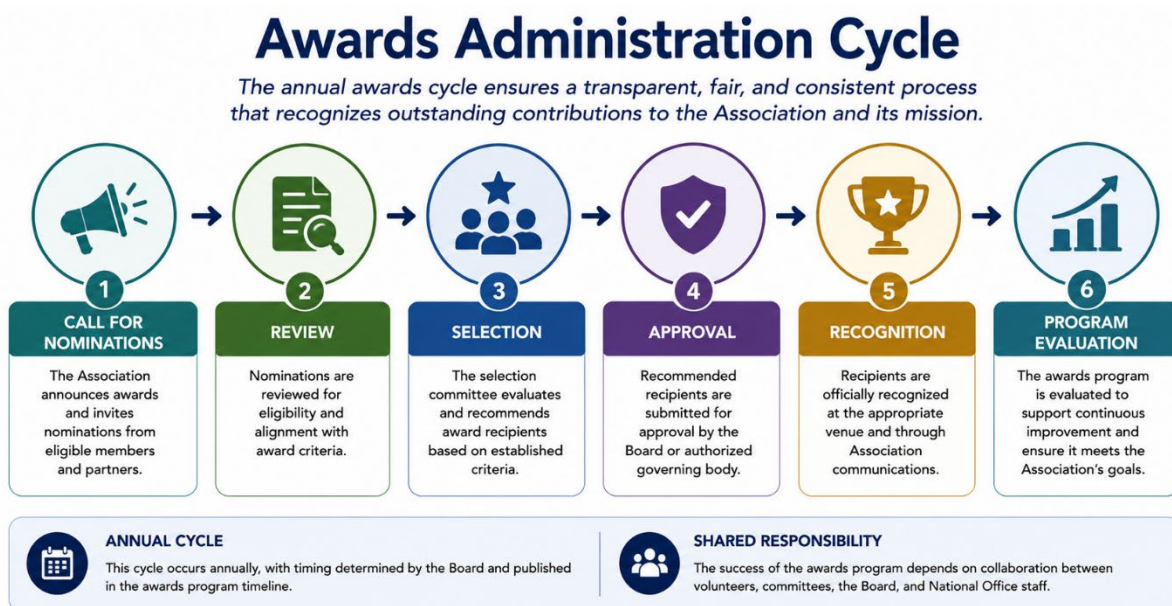


Figure 4.6 Awards Administration Cycle

31.6 Award Selection

Recipients shall be selected through fair, objective, and consistent processes appropriate to each award.

Selection responsibilities may be assigned to the Board of Directors, an Action Committee, a selection committee, a task force, or another body authorized by the Board.

Individuals participating in the selection of award recipients shall disclose and appropriately manage actual, potential, or perceived conflicts of interest and maintain the confidentiality of nomination materials and selection deliberations.

31.7 Responsibilities

Board of Directors

The Board establishes Awards and Recognition policy, approves the creation, modification, or discontinuation of Association awards and major recognition programs, and retains authority over awards reserved to the Board.

Executive Director

The Executive Director administers the Association's Awards and Recognition Program, implements Board-approved policies, coordinates award administration, and maintains official award records.

National Office Staff

National Office staff provide administrative support for nominations, communications, recordkeeping, recognition activities, and other responsibilities assigned by the Executive Director.

Selection Committees and Authorized Review Bodies

Selection committees and other authorized review bodies evaluate nominations, maintain appropriate confidentiality, manage conflicts of interest, and recommend or select recipients in accordance with the authority assigned to them.

Regional Associations

Regional Associations administer the selection of recipients for the Carol Baffi-Dugan Award for Service in accordance with Board-approved criteria and submit their recipients to NAAHP for recognition.

PART V

Board-Approved Policies

*An accessible overview of the separately maintained policies formally approved
by the NAAHP Board of Directors.*

In This Part

32 Official Board Policies105

◆ KEY PRINCIPLE

Official Board policies remain authoritative in their separately approved form; this Manual explains how they relate to Association operations.

32. Official Board Policies

NAAHP maintains certain Board-approved policies as separate official documents. This Part summarizes those policies, identifies primary responsibilities, and directs readers to the current official version. The summaries are provided for orientation and do not replace the approved policy text. If a summary differs from the current approved policy, the separately maintained Board-approved policy controls.

The Executive Director is responsible for maintaining access to the current approved policies, coordinating implementation, and ensuring that superseded versions are retained as official Association records. Policy amendments require approval by the Board of Directors unless the Board has expressly delegated authority for a particular matter.

32.1 Leadership Code of Ethics

Policy title: Leadership Code of Ethics

Approved by: NAAHP Board of Directors

Current version: June 2025

Purpose and scope

The Leadership Code of Ethics establishes the ethical principles and expected conduct for Officers, Directors, staff, and other designated Association leaders. It addresses personal and professional integrity, commitment to the mission, governance accountability, legal compliance, financial stewardship, transparency, program effectiveness, inclusion, fundraising practices, partnerships, and reporting of suspected violations.

Responsibilities

- Association leaders are responsible for understanding and complying with the Code.
- The Board of Directors oversees the ethical governance expectations established by the Code.
- The Executive Director supports implementation, communication, and administration as applicable to staff and Association operations.
- Concerns about possible violations should be reported through the process identified in the official policy.

Official policy: Leadership Code of Ethics, maintained with NAAHP public policies.

32.2 Conflict of Interest Policy and Disclosure

Policy title: Conflict of Interest Policy and Disclosure

Approved by: NAAHP Board of Directors

Current version: Current approved version maintained separately

Purpose and scope

The Conflict of Interest Policy protects the Association when personal, professional, institutional, regional, or financial interests could influence, or appear to influence, an individual's judgment on behalf of NAAHP. The policy establishes disclosure expectations and a process for evaluating and managing actual, potential, or perceived conflicts.

Responsibilities

- Covered individuals must disclose relevant interests promptly and complete required disclosures.
- Individuals with a conflict may be recused from discussion, access to information, recommendation, or decision-making as appropriate.
- The responsible governing body or authorized official determines how a disclosed conflict will be managed and documents the action taken.
- The National Office maintains required disclosure and conflict-management records.

Official policy: Conflict of Interest Policy and applicable disclosure form, maintained with NAAHP public policies.

32.3 Membership Code of Conduct

Policy title: Membership Code of Conduct

Approved by: NAAHP Board of Directors

Current version: Current approved version maintained separately

Purpose and scope

The Membership Code of Conduct establishes standards for respectful, professional, ethical, and lawful conduct by members when participating in Association activities, programs, events, communications, volunteer service, and online communities. It supports an inclusive environment and identifies conduct that may be inconsistent with membership responsibilities.

Responsibilities

- Members are responsible for complying with the Code in all NAAHP settings and activities.
- Individuals may report concerns through the process identified in the official policy.
- The Association reviews reported concerns and may take action consistent with the Bylaws, the official policy, and applicable law.
- The Executive Director coordinates administration of the policy unless the matter requires action by the Board or another authorized body.

Official policy: Membership Code of Conduct, maintained with NAAHP public policies.

32.4 Membership Terms of Service

Policy title: Membership Terms of Service

Approved by: NAAHP Board of Directors

Current version: Current approved version maintained separately

Purpose and scope

The Membership Terms of Service describe the conditions associated with applying for, maintaining, renewing, and using NAAHP membership and member services. They address eligibility, account responsibilities, dues and payments, access to services, acceptable use, termination or suspension, and changes to membership terms.

Responsibilities

- Members and applicants are responsible for providing accurate information and complying with the current terms.
- The Executive Director administers membership operations and applies the terms within Board-approved policy and the Bylaws.
- The National Office maintains membership records, communicates applicable terms, and supports member access to services.
- Questions or disputes requiring governance action are referred to the Board or other authorized body.

Official policy: Membership Terms of Service, maintained as an official public-facing policy or terms document.

32.5 Privacy Policy

Policy title: Privacy Policy

Approved by: NAAHP Board of Directors

Current version: November 9, 2023

Purpose and scope

The Privacy Policy explains how NAAHP collects, uses, protects, shares, and maintains information obtained through membership, programs, events, services, websites, and other Association activities. It addresses personal information, usage information, service providers, information security, third-party websites, policy updates, and individual privacy rights that may apply under law.

Responsibilities

- The Executive Director oversees implementation of privacy practices across Association operations.
- National Office staff and authorized service providers may access and use information only for legitimate Association purposes and within applicable requirements.
- Individuals may submit privacy questions or requests to the National Office.
- Material policy changes requiring Board approval are presented to the Board of Directors.

Official policy: Privacy Policy, maintained with NAAHP public policies.

32.6 Cookie Policy

Policy title: Cookie Policy

Approved by: NAAHP Board of Directors

Current version: October 1, 2024

Purpose and scope

The Cookie Policy explains NAAHP's use of cookies and similar technologies on Association websites. These technologies may support website functionality, user experience, security, analytics, and other services necessary for online operations.

Responsibilities

- The Executive Director oversees implementation of the Cookie Policy and related website practices.
- National Office staff and authorized technology providers administer cookie and website settings within approved policy and applicable law.
- Users are provided information about available choices through the current official policy and applicable website tools.

Official policy: Cookie Policy, maintained with NAAHP public policies.

32.7 Confidentiality Agreement

Policy title: Confidentiality Agreement

Approved by: NAAHP Board of Directors

Current version: June 2025

Purpose and scope

The Confidentiality Agreement applies to Officers, Directors, National Office staff, and other designated Association leaders who may have access to confidential, sensitive, or proprietary information. It defines protected information and establishes obligations concerning access, use, disclosure, return or destruction, ownership, duration of confidentiality, and required acknowledgments.

Responsibilities

- Covered individuals must protect confidential information and use it only for authorized Association purposes.
- Confidential information may be disclosed only when authorized or legally required and handled according to the official agreement.
- Individuals must return or securely destroy Association information when their service ends or when requested.
- The Executive Director coordinates administration and recordkeeping, while matters involving Directors or Officers may require Board or Executive Committee involvement.

Official policy: Confidentiality Agreement and acknowledgment form, maintained with NAAHP public policies.

32.8 Additional and Future Board-Approved Policies

The Board may adopt additional policies that are maintained separately because they are public-facing, legally sensitive, operationally specialized, or expected to require more frequent revision than the Manual. Examples identified in the policy source register include accessibility statements and artificial intelligence guidance, if adopted. A policy should not be represented as adopted until formal Board approval is confirmed.

When a separately maintained policy is adopted, revised, or rescinded, the National Office should update the official policy repository, the Manual cross-reference, and the applicable revision history.

APPENDICES

Reference Materials

Supporting information, organizational summaries, cross-references, revision records, and tools for locating information in the Manual.

In This Part

Appendix A: Organizational Relationships	111
Appendix B: NAAHP Association Programs	112
Appendix C: NAAHP Action Committees	115
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◆ KEY PRINCIPLE

The appendices provide practical reference material without duplicating the policies and explanations contained in the main Parts of the Manual.

Appendix A: Organizational Relationships



Appendix B: NAAHP Association Programs

NAAHP Association Programs are ongoing initiatives established by the Association to advance its mission, support its strategic priorities, and provide meaningful value to members. These programs strengthen the professional community by providing education, leadership development, networking, volunteer engagement, and other resources that support health professions advisors throughout their careers.

This appendix provides a high-level overview of the Association's current programs. It serves as a reference for Board members, Association leaders, volunteers, National Office staff, and members by describing the purpose and general scope of each program.

Program administration, participation requirements, operating procedures, curricula, schedules, and supporting resources are maintained separately by the National Office and are intentionally excluded from this appendix because they may change over time.

The Board of Directors may establish, modify, combine, suspend, or discontinue Association Programs as the needs of the Association and its members evolve.

Association Programs vs. Action Committees

Association Programs provide ongoing services, educational opportunities, leadership development, and member engagement activities that advance the Association's mission. Action Committees, described in Appendix C, are standing volunteer committees that advise and support the Association within specific areas of responsibility. While committees often help guide or support Association Programs, the two serve distinct organizational purposes.

Ambassador Program

Primary Purpose

The Ambassador Program expands awareness of NAAHP by encouraging member engagement and strengthening relationships with prospective members, institutions, regional affiliates, and the broader health professions advising community. Ambassadors serve as advocates for the Association and help connect individuals with NAAHP programs, services, and opportunities.

Areas of Responsibility

- Promote awareness of NAAHP and its mission.
- Encourage participation in Association membership, programs, and services.
- Serve as knowledgeable representatives of the Association.
- Support outreach and member engagement initiatives.
- Foster connections between the Association and the health professions advising community.

NAAHP-Ed

Primary Purpose

NAAHP-Ed is the Association's continuing education program. It provides educational opportunities that support the ongoing professional development of health professions advisors through courses, certificate programs, webinars, and other learning experiences designed to strengthen professional knowledge and practice.

Areas of Responsibility

- Provide continuing education opportunities for members.
- Support lifelong professional learning and skill development.
- Deliver educational programming that reflects emerging trends and best practices.
- Expand access to high-quality professional development resources.
- Support the Association's educational mission through innovative learning opportunities.

NAAHP-Leads

Primary Purpose

NAAHP-Leads is the Association's leadership development program. It prepares and supports current and future volunteer leaders by providing structured leadership development experiences that strengthen individual leadership skills and contribute to the Association's long-term sustainability.

Areas of Responsibility

- Develop leadership knowledge and competencies.
- Prepare members for volunteer leadership roles within the Association.
- Foster collaboration among current and emerging leaders.
- Encourage leadership succession and organizational continuity.
- Support the development of future Association leaders.

New Advisor Development Program

Primary Purpose

The New Advisor Development Program supports professionals who are new to health professions advising by providing foundational educational resources, professional connections, and opportunities that encourage long-term engagement with both the profession and the Association.

Areas of Responsibility

- Support the successful transition of new professionals into health professions advising.
- Provide foundational educational and professional resources.

- Encourage networking, mentoring, and peer support.
- Promote engagement with Association programs, services, and volunteer opportunities.
- Foster continued professional growth and involvement within NAAHP.

Program Administration

Association Programs operate within the policies, strategic direction, and budget established by the Board of Directors. Responsibility for the administration, coordination, and implementation of Association Programs rests with the Executive Director, who may delegate operational responsibilities to National Office staff, Program Coordinators, or volunteers as appropriate.

Program leadership, participation requirements, schedules, educational content, volunteer assignments, and other operational details are maintained separately from this Manual and may be updated as programs evolve without requiring amendment to this appendix.

Related Documents

- Section 20, Association Programs (p. 68)
- Section 21, Volunteer Engagement (p. 70)
- Appendix A, Organizational Relationships (p. 111)
- Appendix C, NAAHP Action Committees (p. 115)

Appendix C: NAAHP Action Committees

NAAHP Action Committees are standing volunteer committees established by the Board of Directors to support the Association's mission through member expertise, collaboration, and service. Each committee focuses on a specific area of the Association's work and provides recommendations, resources, and subject matter expertise within its assigned responsibilities.

This appendix provides a high-level overview of the Association's current Action Committees. It is intended to help Board members, volunteers, National Office staff, and members understand the purpose and responsibilities of each committee.

Committee governance, appointments, authority, and operating expectations are described elsewhere in this Manual. Committee rosters, annual work plans, meeting schedules, and current projects are maintained separately by the National Office and are intentionally excluded from this appendix because they change regularly.

Action Committees serve in an advisory capacity unless the Board expressly delegates additional authority.

Committee on Diversity, Equity & Inclusion

Primary Purpose

The Committee on Diversity, Equity & Inclusion advises the Association on matters that promote diversity, equity, inclusion, belonging, and organizational culture. The committee supports NAAHP by encouraging an inclusive professional community and advancing awareness of issues affecting health professions advising.

Areas of Responsibility

- Advise the Association on diversity, equity, inclusion, and belonging.
- Recommend practices that foster an inclusive organizational culture.
- Support professional development and educational resources related to diversity, equity, and inclusion.
- Encourage dialogue and awareness of issues affecting health professions advisors and students.

Member Engagement Committee

Primary Purpose

The Member Engagement Committee promotes meaningful participation in the Association by fostering connections among members and encouraging active involvement throughout the membership experience.

Areas of Responsibility

- Recommend strategies that strengthen member engagement.
- Encourage participation in Association programs, activities, and volunteer opportunities.
- Support initiatives that enhance the overall member experience.
- Identify opportunities to strengthen connections among members and the Association.

Membership Committee

Primary Purpose

The Membership Committee advises the Association on matters related to membership recruitment, retention, engagement, and member value. The committee helps ensure that NAAHP's membership programs and services continue to support the needs of current and prospective members.

Areas of Responsibility

- Advise on strategies for recruiting and retaining members.
- Recommend initiatives that strengthen the value of NAAHP membership.
- Review membership trends and emerging needs.
- Provide recommendations regarding membership categories, benefits, and services.
- Support efforts to maintain a diverse and engaged membership community.

National Conference Planning Committee

Primary Purpose

The National Conference Planning Committee supports the development of NAAHP's national conference by providing member perspectives and helping shape a high-quality educational and professional development experience.

Areas of Responsibility

- Recommend educational programming and conference content.
- Help ensure the conference reflects the professional interests of NAAHP members.
- Support planning efforts that enhance the overall conference experience.
- Provide member perspectives throughout conference development.

Postbac Committee

Primary Purpose

The Postbac Committee advises the Association on matters affecting post-baccalaureate education and advising. The committee promotes awareness, professional development, and the exchange of information related to post-baccalaureate programs and advisors serving these students.

Areas of Responsibility

- Advise the Association on issues affecting post-baccalaureate education and advising.
- Promote awareness and understanding of post-baccalaureate pathways.
- Encourage the exchange of information and effective practices among advisors.
- Support professional development and educational resources related to post-baccalaureate advising.
- Identify emerging issues affecting post-baccalaureate programs and their students.

Professional Development & Leadership Committee

Primary Purpose

The Professional Development & Leadership Committee supports the professional growth of NAAHP members and the development of current and future Association leaders through educational opportunities, leadership development, and member learning initiatives.

Areas of Responsibility

- Identify professional development needs within the membership.
- Recommend educational resources and learning opportunities.
- Support leadership development for current and emerging Association leaders.
- Encourage lifelong professional growth among health professions advisors.
- Contribute to the Association's educational programming.

Publications & Media Committee

Primary Purpose

The Publications & Media Committee supports the development, quality, and consistency of NAAHP publications, digital resources, and member communications. The committee helps ensure that Association information is accurate, relevant, and valuable to members.

Areas of Responsibility

- Support the development and maintenance of Association publications and digital resources.
- Recommend approaches that promote clear and consistent communications.
- Encourage member contributions to Association publications.
- Advise on the development of member-facing informational resources.

Research Committee

Primary Purpose

The Research Committee promotes research and scholarship that advance the profession of health professions advising. The committee encourages using evidence to inform practice, support members, and strengthen the Association's programs and strategic initiatives.

Areas of Responsibility

- Encourage research related to health professions advising.
- Support opportunities for scholarly collaboration and inquiry.
- Promote the use of research and data to inform professional practice.
- Help make research findings accessible and useful to the membership.
- Identify emerging research topics relevant to the Association.

Committee Administration

This Manual maintains committee membership, leadership appointments, annual priorities, work plans, and operating procedures separately. These administrative matters may change each year and are managed in accordance with Board policy and National Office procedures.

The Board of Directors may establish, modify, combine, or discontinue Action Committees as the Association's strategic priorities evolve.

Related Documents

- Section 17, Action Committees (p. 60)
- Section 15, Nominations and Appointments; Section 21, Volunteer Engagement (pp. 54 and 70)
- Appendix A, Organizational Relationships (p. 111)
- Appendix B, NAAHP Association Programs (p. 112)

Appendix D: Glossary

This glossary defines terms as they are used in this Manual. It is intended as a quick reference and does not replace the full explanation provided in the applicable section or governing document.

Table 3 Glossary of Terms

Term	Definition
Action Committee	A standing volunteer committee established by the Board to advise and support the Association within a defined area of responsibility. Action Committees recommend unless the Board expressly delegates decision-making authority.
Administrative Procedure	A documented process that explains how Board-approved policy or an organizational requirement is implemented. Administrative procedures may not conflict with higher governing authority.
Association Leadership	Board-appointed leaders who serve in designated Association roles outside the Board of Directors, including Action Committee Chairs, Program Coordinators, and other positions identified by the Board.
Association Program	An ongoing initiative established to provide services, education, leadership development, or member engagement in support of NAAHP's mission.
Board Committee	A committee of the Board of Directors that exercises responsibilities assigned by the Bylaws, this Manual, or the Board. Current Board committees include the Executive Committee, Finance Committee, and Nominating Committee.
Board Resolution	A formal action or decision adopted by the Board of Directors and recorded in the official minutes or other approved record.
Delegated Authority	Authority assigned by the Board or another authorized body to an individual or organizational unit for a defined purpose and within stated limits.
Executive Director	The chief executive officer of the Association, responsible for managing operations, leading the National Office, and implementing Board-approved policy and strategic direction.
Governing Documents	The legal and policy authorities that direct the Association, including applicable law, the Articles of Incorporation, the Bylaws, and this Manual.
Manual	The NAAHP Policies & Procedures Manual.

Term	Definition
National Office	The professional staff and administrative operations of the Association under the direction of the Executive Director.
Officer	A person holding an office established by the Bylaws, including President, President-Elect, Immediate Past President, Treasurer, Treasurer-Elect, and Secretary.
Official Association Record	Information created, received, or maintained as evidence of Association decisions, responsibilities, transactions, activities, or legal obligations.
Operational Practice	A routine method, workflow, tool, schedule, or internal arrangement used to conduct day-to-day work under administrative authority.
Policy	A Board-approved requirement, standard, responsibility, authority, limit, or organizational expectation.
Task Force	A temporary body established to address a defined issue, question, or deliverable. A Task Force Lead leads it, and it ends when its charge is completed or discontinued.
Working Group	A time-limited collaborative body that develops, tests, or advances a defined initiative or body of work. A successful Working Group may lead to an Association Program or another continuing structure.

Appendix E: Policy Cross-Reference

This appendix identifies the primary location of major policies and organizational subjects. It is a navigation aid. The full section or separately maintained official policy controls.

Table 4 Policy Cross-Reference

Subject	Primary Location
Action Committees	Section 17 (p. 115) and Appendix C (p. 118)
Association Programs	Section 20 (p. 112) and Appendix B (p. 115)
Association records and information management	Section 27 (p. 89)
Awards and recognition	Section 31 (p. 101)
Board of Directors	Section 7 (p. 23)
Board operations	Section 14 (p. 49)
Confidentiality Agreement	Section 32.7 (p. 105)
Conflict of Interest Policy and Disclosure	Section 32.2 (p. 105)
Contracts and agreements	Section 26 (p. 86)
Cookie Policy	Section 32.6 (p. 105)
Elections and appointments	Section 15 (p. 54)
Executive Committee	Section 9 (p. 30)
Executive Director	Section 12 (p. 40)
External relationships	Section 30 (p. 99)
Finance Committee	Section 10 (p. 33)
Financial management	Section 22 (p. 75)
Governing authority and delegation	Section 4 (p. 15)
Leadership Code of Ethics	Section 32.1 (p. 105)

Subject	Primary Location
Manual administration	Section 5 (p. 17)
Membership Code of Conduct	Section 32.3 (p. 105)
Membership Terms of Service	Section 32.4 (p. 105)
Membership	Section 23 (p. 79)
National Conference and events	Section 24 (p. 81)
Nominating Committee	Section 11 (p. 37)
Officers	Section 8 (p. 26)
Policy and procedure administration	Section 6 (p. 19)
Privacy Policy	Section 32.5 (p. 105)
Publications and communications	Section 25 (p. 84)
Risk management	Section 29 (p. 95)
Task Forces and Working Groups	Sections 18 (p. 66) and 19 (p. 68)
Technology and systems	Section 28 (p. 92)

Appendix F: Index

This simple subject index helps readers locate commonly requested information.

Table 5 Index

Subject	Section or Appendix
Action Committees	Section 17 (p. 115); Appendix C (p. 118)
Administrative procedures	Section 6 (p. 19)
Ambassadors	Section 30 (p. 112); Appendix B (p. 115)
Association Leadership	Section 13 (p. 46)
Association Programs	Section 20 (p. 112); Appendix B (p. 115)
Awards and recognition	Section 31 (p. 101)
Board committees	Sections 9-11 (pp. 30-37)
Board of Directors	Section 7 (pp. 23 and 49); Section 14 (p. 50)
Board operations	Section 14 (p. 49)
Budget and financial management	Section 10 (pp. 33 and 75); Section 22 (p. 78)
Committees	Sections 9-11 (p. 115); Section 17 (p. 62); Appendix C (p. 118)
Confidentiality	Section 27 (pp. 89 and 105); Section 32.7 (p. 109)
Conflict of interest	Section 32.2 (p. 105)
Contracts and agreements	Section 26 (p. 86)
Elections and appointments	Section 15 (p. 54)
Executive Committee	Section 9 (p. 30)
Executive Director	Section 12 (p. 40)

Subject	Section or Appendix
External relationships	Section 30 (p. 99)
Finance Committee	Section 10 (p. 33)
Governing authority	Section 4 (p. 15)
Manual administration	Section 5 (p. 17)
Membership	Section 23 (pp. 79 and 105); Section 32.3-32.4 (p. 109)
National Conference	Section 24 (p. 81)
National Office	Section 12 (pp. 40 and 57); Section 16 (p. 59)
Nominating Committee	Section 11 (p. 37)
Officers	Section 8 (p. 26)
Policies	Section 6 (p. 121); Section 32 (p. 109); Appendix E (p. 123)
Privacy	Section 32.5 (p. 105)
Publications and communications	Section 25 (p. 84)
Records management	Section 27 (p. 89)
Risk management	Section 29 (p. 95)
Task Forces	Section 18 (p. 64)
Technology and systems	Section 28 (p. 92)
Volunteer engagement	Section 21 (p. 70)
Working Groups	Section 19 (p. 66)

NAAHP Policies & Procedures Manual

Version 2026.3

National Association of Advisors for the Health Professions

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Appendix G. Change Log

This log summarizes substantive revisions incorporated into the Manual for Board review. Page references correspond to this edition.

Date	Page	Section	Change
June 21, 2026	31	Section 11. Board of Directors	Added transition language recognizing the Board-approved restructuring of Board composition and regional representation. The revised structure remains pending until the Board establishes an implementation date.
June 21, 2026	37	Section 13. Association Leadership	Clarified that Association leadership eligibility is not categorically restricted by membership category, except where the Bylaws or another Board-approved requirement establishes qualifications for a specific position.
June 21, 2026	43	Section 15. Nominations and Appointments	Updated leadership eligibility and appointment guidance to reflect the Board decision removing membership-category exclusions for Board positions, elected offices, and Association leadership.
June 21, 2026	48	Section 17. Action Committees	Clarified that prior service on an Action Committee is not required for appointment as an Action Committee Chair.
June 22, 2026	58	Section 20. Association Programs	Reviewed program leadership language for consistency with June Board actions. No unsupported changes were made to coordinator responsibilities.
June 22, 2026	67	Section 23. Membership	Updated Association membership provisions to reflect the Board-approved tiered Association membership dues structure.
June 22, 2026	73	Section 26. National Conference	Revised conference leadership terminology to allow a Chair, Co-Chairs, or another Board-approved leadership structure rather than requiring exactly two co-chairs.
June 23, 2026	73	Section 26. National Conference	Confirmed that geographic or regional rotation of National Conference sites is not a governing requirement and removed any implication that such rotation is mandatory.
September 2026	125	Appendices	Reviewed appendix terminology and cross-references for consistency with the June 2026 governance revisions.

September 2026	61, 72	Sections 17 and 21	Clarified that Action Committee composition and regional representation are not prescribed requirements; Committee Chairs determine committee membership. Clarified the use of the Volunteer Request Form and Volunteer Engagement process for open recruitment.
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